INCLINE MY HEART

A Thirty-Day Liturgy

for Morning Devotion

In the Anglican Tradition

Nathanael Thie

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For all who rise early to seek the Lord,

and for those who long to learn

Incline my heart unto thy testimonies,

and not to covetousness.

— Psalm 119:36

PREFACE

This book is offered as a guide for thirty days of morning prayer in the Anglican tradition. It draws upon the riches of the 1662 Book of Common Prayer, the writings of the Church Fathers, and the spiritual wisdom of the saints, while remaining accessible to any Christian who desires to deepen their life of prayer.

The structure of each day follows the ancient pattern of the Daily Office: preparation, confession, adoration, Scripture, creed and prayer, self-examination, and blessing. This rhythm has formed Christians for centuries and remains a trustworthy guide for the soul's approach to God.

The theological vision underlying these devotions is catholic and evangelical in the Anglican sense, rooted in Scripture, formed by the creeds, nourished by the sacraments, and oriented toward the glory of God in Christ. Atonement is understood primarily in terms of Christus Victor and healing.

Each day takes approximately twenty to thirty minutes. You may wish to set aside the same time each morning, creating a holy rhythm that becomes as natural as breathing. Light a candle if you are able; the flame reminds us that we pray in the presence of the One who is Light from Light, true God from true God.

The thirty days are arranged in a deliberate progression. The first week focuses on the great 'I AM' sayings of Christ, establishing who it is we worship. The second week continues exploring Christ's titles and offices. The third week turns to the life of the Spirit and the communion of saints. The fourth week addresses the practices of Christian discipleship and concludes with eschatological hope and the vision of God.

May these prayers form in you the mind of Christ, kindle in you the love of Christ, and bring you at last to the vision of Christ, in whom all our hopes are fulfilled and all our desires satisfied.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

The Seven Movements of Each Day:

I. **PREPARATION OF THE HEART** – Light a candle, keep silence, and pray the opening versicles and invocation. This gathers your scattered thoughts and turns your attention to God.

II. **CONFESSION AND ABSOLUTION** – Kneel and confess your sins, then receive the assurance of pardon. Come honestly before God, trusting in his mercy rather than your merit.

III. **ADORATION** – Stand and pray the psalm or canticle appointed. Let praise lift your heart and remind you whom you worship.

IV. **SCRIPTURE AND MEDITATION** – Sit and receive the Word, then keep silent and consider the meditation points. Listen for God's voice in his Word.

V. **THE CREED AND PRAYERS** – Stand for the Creed, then kneel for the Lord's Prayer, the Collect, and your own

intercessions. Root yourself in the faith of the Church and bring your needs to God.

VI. **SELF-EXAMINATION AND INTENTION** – Consider the questions provided and pray the appointed prayer. Let the Word shape your day.

VII. **COMMENDATION AND BLESSING** – Stand and receive the blessing, then go forth to serve. The blessing sends you into the world carrying what you have received.

Notes on Posture:

The rubrics suggest kneeling, standing, and sitting at various points. These postures are not arbitrary but form the body even as the words form the soul. Standing expresses reverence and readiness; kneeling expresses humility and supplication; sitting expresses receptivity and attention. If physical limitations prevent these postures, adapt as needed – God sees the heart.

Notes on the Calendar:

These thirty days may be used beginning on any date. However, you may wish to begin on the first day of a month, or on the first Sunday of Advent, Lent, or Eastertide. The devotions are not tied to the Church calendar but may be enriched by its rhythms.

Introduction

This devotional stands in the tradition of the Anglican divines who understood that prayer is not merely an exercise of private devotion but a participation in the ceaseless worship of the whole Church, militant here on earth and triumphant in heaven. The structure herein draws from the Daily Office tradition reaching back through Cranmer to the monastic hours, while the theological substance reflects the classical Anglican via media: catholic in its appreciation for mystery, sacrament, and the communion of saints; reformed in its commitment to Scripture as the sufficient rule of faith; and patristic in its interpretive sensibilities.

Each day's office follows a sevenfold pattern, mirroring both the ancient hours and the mystical significance of seven as the number of completeness:

I. **Preparation of the Heart** – silence, invocation, and the recognition of God's presence
II. **Confession and Absolution** – acknowledging our poverty before the God of all mercy
III. **Adoration** – psalms, canticles, and hymns of praise
IV. **Scripture and Meditation** – lectio divina upon the appointed reading
V. **The Creed and Prayers** – affirming the faith and bringing our petitions

VI. **Self-Examination and Intention** – preparing the heart for the day's calling

VII. **Commendation and Blessing** – offering ourselves to God's service

The theology animating these pages is unashamedly that of Hooker, Andrewes, Taylor, and the Prayer Book tradition. Here you will find no anxious speculation about divine decrees, but rather a confident resting in the revealed character of God as the Father who wills the salvation of all, the Son who has accomplished that salvation in His incarnation, passion, and resurrection, and the Spirit who applies that salvation through Word and Sacrament in the life of the Church. The atonement is understood not primarily as a juridical transaction but as the victory of Christ over sin, death, and the devil (the Christus Victor of the Fathers) and as the offering of perfect human obedience in our nature by which we are healed and restored to communion with God.

May these prayers form your heart in the ancient way, that rising each morning you may present yourself as a living sacrifice, holy and acceptable unto God, which is your reasonable service.

A Note on Use: These devotions are designed for approximately 20-30 minutes of focused prayer. The rubrics (in red italic) offer guidance but should serve your prayer, not constrain it. Where silence is indicated, linger as the Spirit leads. Where meditation points are offered, pursue whichever draws your heart most deeply into God.

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THE FIRST DAY

The Call to Awakening

I. Preparation of the Heart

Find a quiet place. Light a candle if you wish, as a sign of Christ's presence. Sit in silence for one full minute, allowing the noise of the night to settle and the awareness of God's presence to arise.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pause briefly in the Trinitarian name, acknowledging the mystery of the God who is eternally self-giving love.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel if able. Examine briefly the state of your heart – not with anxious introspection but with honest recognition of your need for grace.

Almighty and most merciful Father, we have erred and strayed from thy ways like lost sheep. We have followed too much the devices and desires of our own hearts. We have offended against thy holy laws. We have left undone those things which we ought to have done; and we have done those things which we ought not to have done; and there is no health in us.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us, miserable offenders. Spare thou those, O God, who confess their faults. Restore thou those who are penitent; according to thy promises declared unto mankind in Christ Jesus our Lord.

And grant, O most merciful Father, for his sake, that we may hereafter live a godly, righteous and sober life, to the glory of thy holy Name. Amen.

Hear the word of absolution, receiving it not as mere information but as the very word of Christ spoken to you:

The Almighty and merciful Lord grant you absolution and remission of all your sins, true repentance, amendment of life, and the grace and consolation of his Holy Spirit. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray the Venite, the ancient morning psalm that has called the Church to worship since the earliest centuries:

Psalm 95:1-7

O come, let us sing unto the Lord;

let us heartily rejoice in the strength of our salvation.

Let us come before his presence with thanksgiving,

and show ourselves glad in him with psalms.

For the Lord is a great God,

and a great King above all gods.

In his hand are all the corners of the earth,

and the strength of the hills is his also.

The sea is his, and he made it,

and his hands prepared the dry land.

O come, let us worship and fall down,

and kneel before the Lord our Maker.

For he is the Lord our God,

and we are the people of his pasture, and the sheep of his hand.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Read the passage slowly, aloud if possible, as one receiving a letter from a beloved friend.

Genesis 1:1-5

In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth. And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters. And God said, Let there be light: and there was light. And God saw the light, that it was good: and God divided the light from the darkness. And God called the light Day, and the darkness he called Night. And the evening and the morning were the first day.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider these points for meditation:

1. Creation begins not with emptiness but with the brooding presence of the Spirit over chaos. So too your day: before you have done anything, before you have achieved or failed, the Spirit hovers over the formless moments waiting to bring forth life.

2. God's creative act is speech – 'Let there be.' In the beginning was the Word, and by that Word all things were made. When God speaks, reality answers. Consider: what word is God speaking over your life this day?

3. Light is called 'good' before it has done anything useful, before it has illuminated any path or warmed any creature. Its goodness is in its being, not its function. So too with you: your worth before God is not in your usefulness but in your being, held in existence by his love.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation, allowing one of these points to deepen in your heart.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand. Recite the Apostles' Creed, the ancient baptismal symbol, uniting your voice with Christians across all ages:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit. Pray the Lord's Prayer slowly, pausing at each petition:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, following this ancient pattern:

For the Church...

For the world and its rulers...

For those who suffer...

For the faithful departed...

For yourself and your own needs...

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

In silence, consider the day ahead. What challenges await? What opportunities for love, patience, or faithfulness will present themselves? Offer them to God:

Lord, I know not what this day will bring, but I know whose I am. In the tasks appointed, grant me diligence without anxiety. In the relationships given, grant me patience without resignation.

In the temptations that will surely come, grant me vigilance without fear. Let me walk this day as one who has already been found, already been loved, already been claimed by thee. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand. Make the sign of the cross if you wish.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit, be with us all evermore. Amen.

Go forth into the day. The office is ended, but the prayer continues in life.

THE SECOND DAY

The Word Made Flesh

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware of Christ's presence with you – closer than your own breath, nearer than your own thoughts.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from Lancelot Andrewes:

O Lord, hear; O Lord, forgive; O Lord, hearken and do; defer not, for thine own sake, O my God. Blessed art thou, O Lord, the God of our fathers, who turnest the shadow of death into morning. Kindle thou in our hearts the fire of thy love, that we may arise and give thanks to thee, and meditate on thy word, and go forth to serve thee this day. Through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Enter into the prayer of confession with the whole church.

Almighty God, Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, Maker of all things, Judge of all men: We acknowledge and bewail our manifold sins and

wickedness, which we from time to time most grievously have committed, by thought, word, and deed, against thy divine Majesty, provoking most justly thy wrath and indignation against us.

We do earnestly repent, and are heartily sorry for these our misdoings; the remembrance of them is grievous unto us, the burden of them is intolerable. Have mercy upon us, have mercy upon us, most merciful Father; for thy Son our Lord Jesus Christ's sake, forgive us all that is past; and grant that we may ever hereafter serve and please thee in newness of life, to the honour and glory of thy Name; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

Almighty God, who desireth not the death of a sinner but rather that all should turn from their wickedness and live, hath given power and commandment to his ministers to declare and pronounce to his people, being penitent, the absolution and remission of their sins. May he pardon and deliver you from all your sins, confirm and strengthen you in all goodness, and bring you to everlasting life; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray the Gloria in Excelsis, the angelic hymn given to the Church from the night of Christ's nativity:

Glory be to God on high.

and on earth peace, good will towards men.

We praise thee, we bless thee,

we worship thee, we glorify thee,

we give thanks to thee for thy great glory,

O Lord God, heavenly King, God the Father Almighty.

O Lord, the only-begotten Son, Jesus Christ;

O Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father,

that takest away the sins of the world,

have mercy upon us.

Thou that takest away the sins of the world,

receive our prayer.

Thou that sittest at the right hand of God the Father,

have mercy upon us.

For thou only art holy;

thou only art the Lord;

thou only, O Christ, with the Holy Ghost,

art most high in the glory of God the Father. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the Word made flesh speaking through the written word:

John 1:1-5, 14

In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. The same was in the beginning with God. All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made. In him was life; and the life was the light of men. And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not... And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we

beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. The Word who spoke creation into being did not remain at a safe distance from his creatures. He 'dwelt among us' – literally, 'pitched his tent' with us, as once he dwelt in the tabernacle with Israel. The infinite has made itself intimate.
2. The Incarnation is not a divine rescue mission that leaves our humanity behind but a taking up of our nature into the life of God. What Christ assumed, Christ healed. In him, your flesh, this very flesh, weary and prone to sin, is declared capable of bearing divine glory.
3. The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness has not 'comprehended' it; has not understood it, has not overcome it, has not extinguished it. Whatever darkness you face this day, remember: darkness can neither understand nor defeat the light that has come to you in Christ.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven,

and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray the Collect for the Incarnation:

Almighty God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son to take our nature upon him, and as at this time to be born of a pure Virgin: Grant that we being regenerate, and made thy children by adoption and grace, may daily be renewed by thy Holy Spirit; through the same our Lord Jesus Christ, who liveth and reigneth with thee and the same Spirit, ever one God, world without end.

Amen.

Add your own intercessions.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: The Word became flesh to dwell with sinners, outcasts, and the broken. Who in your life this day needs to encounter Christ's incarnate presence through you?

Lord Jesus Christ, who for our sake became poor that we through thy poverty might become rich: make me this day an instrument of

thy incarnate love. Where there is flesh that suffers, let me be thy hands of comfort. Where there is flesh that hungers, let me be thy provision. Where there is flesh that is lonely, let me be thy presence. For thou hast joined thyself to our nature, and in loving my neighbour I love thee. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Christ, the Sun of Righteousness, shine upon you and scatter the darkness from before your path; and the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be among you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE THIRD DAY

The Bread of Life

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, allowing your hunger – spiritual, emotional, physical – to rise into awareness before the God who feeds.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from Sarum Primer:

O God, who hast prepared for them that love thee such good things as pass man's understanding: Pour into our hearts such love toward thee, that we, loving thee in all things and above all things, may obtain thy promises, which exceed all that we can desire; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess with particular attention to the ways you have sought satisfaction apart from God:

Most merciful God, we confess that we have sinned against thee in thought, word, and deed, by what we have done, and by what we

have left undone. We have not loved thee with our whole heart; we have not loved our neighbours as ourselves. We have sought our bread from sources that cannot satisfy. We have filled ourselves with that which does not nourish. We have neglected the feast thou hast spread before us.

We are truly sorry and we humbly repent. For the sake of thy Son Jesus Christ, have mercy on us and forgive us; that we may delight in thy will, and walk in thy ways, to the glory of thy Name. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

Almighty God have mercy on you, forgive you all your sins through our Lord Jesus Christ, strengthen you in all goodness, and by the power of the Holy Spirit keep you in eternal life. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 34:1-8

I will bless the Lord at all times;

his praise shall continually be in my mouth.

My soul shall make her boast in the Lord;

the humble shall hear thereof, and be glad.

O magnify the Lord with me,

and let us exalt his Name together.

I sought the Lord, and he heard me,

and delivered me from all my fears.

They looked unto him, and were lightened;

and their faces were not ashamed.

This poor man cried, and the Lord heard him,

and saved him out of all his troubles.

The angel of the Lord encampeth round about them that fear him,

and delivereth them.

O taste and see that the Lord is good;

blessed is the man that trusteth in him.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the Bread of Life.

John 6:32-35, 47-51

Then Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Moses gave you not that bread from heaven; but my Father giveth you the true bread from heaven. For the bread of God is he which cometh down from heaven, and giveth life unto the world. Then said they unto him, Lord, evermore give us this bread. And Jesus said unto them, I am the bread of life: he that cometh to me shall never hunger; and he that believeth on me shall never thirst... Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me hath everlasting life. I am that bread of life. Your fathers did eat manna in the wilderness, and are dead. This is the bread which cometh down from heaven, that a man may eat

thereof, and not die. I am the living bread which came down from heaven: if any man eat of this bread, he shall live for ever: and the bread that I will give is my flesh, which I will give for the life of the world.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. The manna in the wilderness sustained Israel's bodies but could not give eternal life. Christ offers himself as bread that satisfies not merely physical hunger but the deepest hunger of the human soul – the hunger for life that does not end, for love that does not fail.
2. "The bread that I will give is my flesh." Christ does not offer an idea or a philosophy but his very self. In the Eucharist, the Church receives this gift again and again – not as mere symbol but as the true participation in Christ's body given for the life of the world.
3. "He that cometh to me shall never hunger." What hungers drive your life? The hunger for recognition. for security, for control? Christ does not condemn these hungers but invites them toward their satisfaction in himself.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven,

and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this Eucharistic thanksgiving from Jeremy Taylor:

O blessed Jesu, who hast commanded us to come unto thee with hunger, that we may be filled: grant that I may so hunger and thirst after righteousness, that I may be satisfied with thy presence and thy grace. Feed me with the bread of tears if it please thee, so thou also givest me the bread of life. Let my soul be satisfied as with marrow and fatness when I praise thee; and let me never cease to hunger till I sit down at thy table in thy kingdom, to be fed eternally with the revelation of thy glorious face. Amen.

Add your own intercessions.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: Where are you seeking satisfaction in things that cannot satisfy? What false bread are you eating?

Lord Jesus Christ, true Bread from heaven: I confess that I have sought my life in a thousand places that are not thee. I have gorged

on the bread of anxious striving and found myself still hungry. I have eaten the bread of others' approval and remained famished. This day, wean me from every bread that leaves me empty. Draw me to thy table, where alone I find my fill. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Go forth into the world in peace; be of good courage; hold fast that which is good; render to no man evil for evil; strengthen the fainthearted; support the weak; help the afflicted; honour all men; love and serve the Lord, rejoicing in the power of the Holy Spirit. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you forever. Amen.

THE FOURTH DAY

The Good Shepherd

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, allowing yourself to be known – vulnerably, completely – by the Shepherd who calls his sheep by name.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from Augustine:

O Lord our God, grant us grace to desire thee with our whole heart, that so desiring we may seek and find thee; and so finding thee, may love thee; and loving thee, may hate those sins from which thou hast redeemed us; through Jesus Christ our Lord, who liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, world without end. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as sheep who have wandered:

Good Shepherd, I confess that I have strayed from thy paths into ways of my own choosing. I have followed my own voice rather than

thine. I have sought green pastures where there was only barrenness. I have drunk from streams that were polluted with sin. I have wandered into danger, thinking myself safe.

But thou hast come seeking me. Thou hast left the ninety-nine to find me in my lostness. For thy mercy which will not let me go, I give thee thanks. Restore me to the fold. Heal my wounds. Keep me close to thee, that I may hear thy voice and follow only thee. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The Lord is your shepherd. He restores your soul. He leads you in paths of righteousness for his name's sake. Your sins are forgiven; go in peace. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 23:

The Lord is my shepherd;

I shall not want.

He maketh me to lie down in green pastures;

he leadeth me beside the still waters.

He restoreth my soul;

he leadeth me in the paths of righteousness for his Name's sake.

Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death,

I will fear no evil;

for thou art with me;

thy rod and thy staff, they comfort me.

Thou preparest a table before me in the presence of mine enemies;

thou anointest my head with oil;

my cup runneth over.

Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life,

and I will dwell in the house of the Lord for ever.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Hear the voice of the Good Shepherd:

John 10:11-16

I am the good shepherd: the good shepherd giveth his life for the sheep. But he that is an hireling, and not the shepherd, whose own the sheep are not, seeth the wolf coming, and leaveth the sheep, and fleeth: and the wolf catcheth them, and scattereth the sheep. The hireling fleeth, because he is an hireling, and careth not for the sheep. I am the good shepherd, and know my sheep, and am known of mine. As the Father knoweth me, even so know I the Father: and I lay down my life for the sheep. And other sheep I have, which are not of this fold: them also I must bring, and they shall hear my voice; and there shall be one fold, and one shepherd.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. The Good Shepherd 'giveth his life for the sheep.' This is not reluctant sacrifice but joyful gift. Christ's death was not wrested from him by an angry Father but freely offered in love. He ran toward the cross to save you.
2. 'I know my sheep, and am known of mine.' The Shepherd does not know you as a number in a flock but by name, intimately, completely. He knows your wanderings, your weaknesses, your wounds – and loves you still.
3. 'Other sheep I have, which are not of this fold.' The Shepherd's love is not tribal or exclusive. He is gathering a people from every nation, tribe, and tongue. Your belonging to him binds you to all whom he calls.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for guidance:

O God, who hast prepared for them that love thee such good things as pass man's understanding: Pour into our hearts such love toward thee, that we, loving thee above all things, may obtain thy promises, which exceed all that we can desire. Lead us, Good Shepherd, in paths we cannot see to places we have not imagined, trusting that thy rod and thy staff are ever near; through Jesus Christ our Lord, who liveth and reigneth with thee in the unity of the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those who wander and those who lead.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: In what ways are you tempted to follow voices other than the Shepherd's? What wolves threaten your soul, and from what does the Shepherd protect you?

Lord Jesus, Good Shepherd of my soul: teach me this day to recognise thy voice amidst all the clamouring voices that compete for my attention. When the voice of ambition calls me to stray, let me hear thee. When the voice of fear would drive me to panic, let me hear thee. When the voice of comfort would lull me to sleep, let me hear thee. And hearing, let me follow – nowhere else, nothing else, no one else but thee. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Now unto him that is able to keep you from falling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory with exceeding joy, to the only wise God our Saviour, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and ever. Amen.

THE FIFTH DAY

The True Vine

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware of your connection to Christ – not as mere belief but as organic union, as branch to vine.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from Anselm:

O Lord my God, teach my heart this day where and how to see thee, where and how to find thee. Thou hast made me and re-made me, and thou hast bestowed on me all the good things I possess, and still I do not know thee. I have not yet done that for which I was made. Teach me to seek thee, for I cannot seek thee unless thou teach me, or find thee unless thou reveal thyself. Let me seek thee in longing, and long for thee in seeking. Let me find thee in love, and love thee in finding. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as a branch that has tried to bear fruit apart from the vine:

Merciful Father, I confess that I have tried to live as though I were not dependent on thee. I have attempted to bear fruit by my own effort, to grow by my own strength, to flourish by my own resources. I have forgotten that apart from Christ I can do nothing.

I have neglected the disciplines that keep me connected to the vine. I have let the channel of prayer grow clogged with distraction. I have starved myself of thy word. I have isolated myself from thy people. Forgive me, and restore the flow of thy life through me. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The vinedresser tends his vine with mercy. Your failures are forgiven. Your dead branches are pruned away that you may bear much fruit. Receive the gift of grace that flows from Christ your life. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 80:8-11, 14-19:

Thou hast brought a vine out of Egypt;

thou hast cast out the heathen, and planted it.

Thou preparedst room before it,

and didst cause it to take deep root, and it filled the land.

The hills were covered with the shadow of it,

and the boughs thereof were like the goodly cedars.

She sent out her boughs unto the sea,

and her branches unto the river.

Return, we beseech thee, O God of hosts;

look down from heaven, and behold, and visit this vine,

And the vineyard which thy right hand hath planted,

and the branch that thou madest strong for thyself.

Let thy hand be upon the man of thy right hand,

upon the son of man who thou madest strong for thyself.

So will not we go back from thee;

quicken us, and we will call upon thy Name.

Turn us again, O Lord God of hosts;

cause thy face to shine, and we shall be saved.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Abide in the Word:

John 15:1-8

I am the true vine, and my Father is the husbandman. Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away: and every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit. Now ye are clean through the word which I have spoken unto you.

Abide in me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, except it abide in the vine; no more can ye, except ye abide in me. I am the vine, ye are the branches: He that abideth in me, and I in him, the same bringeth forth much fruit: for without me ye can do nothing. If a man abide not in me, he is cast forth as a branch, and is withered; and men gather them, and cast them into the fire, and they are burned. If ye abide in me, and my words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you. Herein is my Father glorified, that ye bear much fruit; so shall ye be my disciples.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'Apart from me ye can do nothing.' This is not a threat but a liberation. You are not responsible for producing fruit by your own effort. The sap, the life, the power – all flow from Christ. Your only task is to remain connected.
2. The vinedresser prunes every branch 'that it may bring forth more fruit.' The cutting away of dead wood is not punishment but care. What in your life needs pruning? What deadness needs to be cut away so that life may flourish?
3. 'Abide in me.' The word means 'remain,' 'dwell,' 'make your home.' This is not occasional visitation but permanent residence. Your address is 'in Christ.' Every other location is temporary accommodation.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for fruitfulness:

O God, the King of glory, who hast exalted thine only Son Jesus Christ with great triumph unto thy kingdom in heaven: We beseech thee, leave us not comfortless, but send to us thine Holy Spirit to comfort us, and exalt us unto the same place whither our Saviour Christ is gone before; who liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, world without end. And grant that by his indwelling power we may bear much fruit, for therein is the Father glorified. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for growth in holiness and love.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What fruit is the Spirit seeking to produce in you this day? What is the next step of growth to which you are being called?

Lord Jesus, True Vine in whom I live: I surrender to thee the illusion of my self-sufficiency. I have tried to produce by effort what can only come by abiding. This day, I choose to remain. When the world pulls me toward frantic activity, remind me to abide. When my own ambition pushes me toward striving, draw me back to abiding. Let the sap of thy Spirit flow through me, that I may bear fruit that remains – love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control – for thy glory and the good of the world. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

The Lord bless you and keep you. The Lord make his face to shine upon you and be gracious unto you. The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace, this day and evermore.

Amen.

THE SIXTH DAY

The Resurrection and the Life

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware that you stand in the presence of the Living One – he who was dead and is alive forevermore.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this Easter invocation from the ancient Paschal liturgy:

O God, who for our redemption didst give thine only-begotten Son to the death of the Cross, and by his glorious resurrection hast delivered us from the power of our enemy: Grant us so to die daily to sin, that we may evermore live with him in the joy of his resurrection; through the same thy Son Christ our Lord, who liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and for ever. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has lived as though death were the final word:

Almighty and everlasting God, I confess that I have lived this past day as though the resurrection were not true. I have been mastered by fear of death in all its forms – fear of failure, fear of loss, fear of the unknown. I have grieved as those who have no hope. I have clung to what is passing as though it were permanent, and neglected what is eternal as though it were distant.

Yet thou hast conquered death. Thou hast burst the bonds of the grave. Thou hast opened the kingdom of heaven to all believers. Forgive my faithless living. Raise me this day to walk in newness of life, as one who knows that the worst thing is never the last thing. Through Jesus Christ, the Resurrection and the Life. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

Christ is risen from the dead, trampling down death by death, and upon those in the tombs bestowing life. Your sins are forgiven. Death no longer has dominion over you. Rise, and walk in the light of the resurrection. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 118:14-24, the great Paschal psalm:

The Lord is my strength and song,

and is become my salvation.

The voice of rejoicing and salvation

is in the tabernacles of the righteous:

the right hand of the Lord doeth valiantly.

The right hand of the Lord is exalted;

the right hand of the Lord doeth valiantly.

I shall not die, but live,

and declare the works of the Lord.

The Lord hast chastened me sore,

but he hath not given me over unto death.

Open to me the gates of righteousness;

I will go into them, and I will praise the Lord.

This is the gate of the Lord,

into which the righteous shall enter.

I will praise thee, for thou hast heard me,

and art become my salvation.

The stone which the builders refused

is become the head stone of the corner.

This is the Lord's doing;

it is marvellous in our eyes.

This is the day which the Lord hath made;

we will rejoice and be glad in it.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of life from the Lord of life:

John 11:21-27

Then said Martha unto Jesus Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died. But I know, that even now, whatsoever thou wilt ask of God, God will give it thee. Jesus saith unto her, Thy brother shall rise again. Martha saith unto him, I know that he shall rise again in the resurrection at the last day. Jesus said unto her, I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live: And whosoever liveth and believeth in me shall never die. Believest thou this? She saith unto him, Yea, Lord: I believe that thou art the Christ, the Son of God, which should come into the world.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. Martha believed in resurrection as a doctrine; 'at the last day.' Jesus redirects her gaze from a future event to a present Person: 'I am the resurrection.' The hope of eternal life is not primarily about when but about whom. Do you know Christ, or only facts about him?
2. 'Though he were dead, yet shall he live.' Christ does not merely resuscitate corpses but bestows a quality of life that death cannot touch. The life he gives is his own eternal life shared with mortal creatures – theosis, participation in the divine nature.
3. 'Believest thou this?' The question comes to you this morning. Not 'Do you understand this?' or 'Can you explain this?' but 'Do you trust this?' Faith is not intellectual assent but personal entrustment to a Person who holds the keys of death and Hades.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending especially to the words concerning resurrection:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for Easter faith:

O God, who through thine only-begotten Son Jesus Christ hast overcome death and opened unto us the gate of everlasting life: Grant that we, who celebrate the solemnities of the Lord's resurrection, may by the renewing of thy Spirit rise from the dead of sin unto the life of righteousness; through the same Jesus Christ our

Lord, who liveth and reigneth with thee in the unity of the same Spirit, one God, world without end. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for the dying and the bereaved.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What deaths, literal or metaphorical, haunt your life with fear? What would it mean to live this day as one for whom death has been conquered?

Lord Jesus Christ, Resurrection and Life: I bring to thee the deaths that shadow my days, the death of hopes unfulfilled, the death of relationships broken, the death of dreams surrendered, the death that awaits my body. Into thy nail-pierced hands I place them all. Thou who hast descended into the deepest darkness and emerged victorious, walk with me through every valley of shadow. Let me not be mastered by fear of any death, for thou art the Living One, and in thee I cannot finally die. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord. Alleluia, alleluia.
Thanks be to God. Alleluia, alleluia.

The God of peace, who brought again from the dead our Lord Jesus Christ, the great Shepherd of the sheep, through the blood of the everlasting covenant, make you perfect in every good work to do his will, working in you that which is well-pleasing in his sight; and the

blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be among you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE SEVENTH DAY

The Way, the Truth, and the Life

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, releasing the many paths you have pursued, and turning your attention to the One who is himself the Way.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from Thomas à Kempis:

O Lord Jesus Christ, thou Way without which no man cometh to the Father, thou Truth which cannot deceive, thou Life which alone can satisfy the immortal soul: I beseech thee, suffer me not to stray from thee who art the Way, nor to distrust thee who art the Truth, nor to rest in anything other than thee who art the Life. Teach me what to do, what to believe, wherein to take my rest. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has wandered from the Way:

Merciful Father, I confess that I have sought many ways to come to thee; ways of my own devising, ways that promise shortcuts to

blessing, ways that avoid the narrow gate and the hard road. I have treated thy truth as one option among many, and thy life as supplement rather than source.

I have believed lies about myself, about thee, about the world. I have exchanged the truth for comfortable falsehoods. I have sought life in a thousand dead ends.

Forgive my wandering. Forgive my unbelief. Forgive my restless seeking after when thou hast already given. Set my feet again upon the Way who is Christ, establish my heart in the Truth who is Christ, and fill me with the Life who is Christ, that I may walk surely homeward to thee.

Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The Lord who is the Way has sought thee in thy wandering and found thee. The Lord who is the Truth speaks over thee the true word of forgiveness. The Lord who is the Life breathes into thee new life this day. Thy sins are forgiven; go in peace. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 86:11-17

Teach me thy way, O Lord;

I will walk in thy truth;

unite my heart to fear thy Name.

I will praise thee, O Lord my God, with all my heart.

and I will glorify thy Name for evermore.

For great is thy mercy toward me,

and thou hast delivered my soul from the lowest hell.

O God, the proud are risen against me,

and the assemblies of violent men have sought after my soul,

and have not set thee before them.

But thou, O Lord, art a God full of compassion, and gracious,

long-suffering, and plenteous in mercy and truth.

O turn unto me, and have mercy upon me;

give thy strength unto thy servant,

and save the son of thine handmaid.

Show me a token for good,

that they which hate me may see it, and be ashamed;

because thou, Lord, hast holpen me, and comforted me.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the self-revelation of Christ:

John 14:1-6

Let not your heart be troubled: ye believe in God, believe also in me. In my Father's house are many mansions: if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you. And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and receive you unto myself; that where I am, there ye may be also. And whither I go ye know, and the way ye know. Thomas saith unto him, Lord, we know not whither thou goest; and how can we know the way? Jesus saith unto him, I am the way, the truth, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. Thomas asked for directions: Jesus offered himself. 'I am the way' – not 'I will show you the way' or 'I will teach you the way.' Christ does not merely point to the Father; he is the Father's accessibility. To know Christ is to have arrived, even while still journeying.
2. 'I am the truth.' In a world of competing claims and alternative facts, Christ stands as the one in whom reality coheres. All truth is his truth. Every genuine insight, every valid discovery, every authentic wisdom participates in him whether it knows it or not.
3. 'I am the life.' Not merely the giver of life but life itself; the source from which all living things derive their existence, the spring that never runs dry, the fire that kindles every lesser flame. To be united to Christ is to be plugged into the power source of the universe.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for guidance in truth:

O God, who hast prepared for them that love thee such good things as pass man's understanding: Pour into our hearts such love toward thee, that we, loving thee in all things and above all things, may obtain thy promises, which exceed all that we can desire. Guide us in the way of truth, deliver us from every error and falsehood, and bring us at last to the Father's house where many mansions await; through Jesus Christ our Lord, who is the Way, the Truth, and the Life. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those who seek truth and those who are lost.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What false paths tempt you? What lies have you believed about God, yourself, or others? What sources of life have you pursued apart from Christ?

Lord Jesus Christ, Way, Truth, and Life: This day I choose thee. When the broad way beckons with its ease, let me choose the narrow way that leads to life. When lies whisper comfort, let me cling to thy hard truth. When counterfeit life offers quick satisfaction, let me wait for the true life that flows from thee alone. Be my map, my compass, my destination. Be the ground beneath my feet and the horizon before my eyes. I have no other way, no other truth, no other life. Thou art enough. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Guide us waking, O Lord, and guard us sleeping, that awake we may watch with Christ, and asleep we may rest in peace. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE EIGHTH DAY

The Light of the World

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle with particular attention this day, watching the flame dispel the darkness around it. Keep one minute of silence, allowing the Light of Christ to illuminate the hidden places of your heart.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from the Phos Hilaron, the ancient evening hymn sung at the lighting of lamps since the second century:

O gladsome Light of the holy glory of the Immortal Father, heavenly, holy, blessed Jesus Christ. Now that we have come to the setting of the sun and behold the light of evening, we praise thee: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, God. Thou art worthy at all times to be praised by happy voices, O Son of God, O Giver of life, and to be glorified through all the worlds. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has preferred darkness to light:

O God, whose blessed Son came into the world that he might destroy the works of the devil and make us children of light: I confess that I have loved darkness rather than light because my deeds have been evil. I have hidden from thy searching gaze. I have preferred the shadows where my sins could not be seen. I have shunned the exposure of truth.

Yet even in my hiding thou hast pursued me with light. Even in my darkness thou hast not abandoned me. Forgive my love of shadows. Heal my eyes that cannot bear thy brightness. Draw me into thy marvellous light, that I may walk as a child of the day. Through Jesus Christ, the Light that shines in the darkness. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

Arise, shine, for your light has come, and the glory of the Lord has risen upon you. The Light of the world has looked upon you with mercy. Your sins, once hidden in darkness, are brought into the light of forgiveness and dissolved. Go forth as a child of light. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 27:1-5

The Lord is my light and my salvation;

whom shall I fear?

The Lord is the strength of my life;

of whom shall I be afraid?

When the wicked, even mine enemies and my foes,

came upon me to eat up my flesh,

they stumbled and fell.

Though an host should encamp against me,

my heart shall not fear;

though war should rise against me,

in this will I be confident.

One thing have I desired of the Lord,

that will I seek after:

that I may dwell in the house of the Lord

all the days of my life,

to behold the beauty of the Lord,

and to enquire in his temple.

For in the time of trouble he shall hide me in his pavilion;

in the secret of his tabernacle shall he hide me;

he shall set me up upon a rock.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the Light that enlightens every person:

John 8:12, 9:1-5

Then spake Jesus again unto them, saying, I am the light of the world: he that followeth me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life… And as Jesus passed by, he saw a man which was blind from his birth. And his disciples asked him, saying, Master, who did sin, this man, or his parents, that he was born blind? Jesus answered, Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents: but that the works of God should be made manifest in him. I must work the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work. As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. The disciples saw the blind man and asked about causation – whose sin? Jesus saw the man and spoke of purpose, that God's works might be displayed. Light changes how we see suffering: not punishment to be explained but occasion for grace to be revealed.
2. 'He that followeth me shall not walk in darkness.' Following is the key. Light does not help those who stand still, admiring it from a distance. To receive Christ's illumination requires movement, step by step in his direction, even when the next step is all we can see.
3. 'The night cometh, when no man can work.' There is urgency in the Light's presence. The day for work is now. The opportunity for service is today. The light that shines on your path this morning illuminates a calling that must be answered before evening falls.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for illumination:

O God, who commandest the light to shine out of darkness, and who hast again brought us to the beginning of this day: Shine into our hearts, that we may neither love nor do anything contrary to thee. Keep us this day from all sin and evil, and direct our thoughts, words, and works to the fulfilling of thy righteous will; through Jesus Christ our Lord, the true Light that lighteth every man that cometh into the world. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those in spiritual darkness and those who bring light to others.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What darkness in your life needs the Light of Christ? What areas have you kept hidden from his illumination? How are you called to be light for others this day?

Lord Jesus Christ, Light of the world: I open to thee the dark places of my heart, the corners I have hidden from others and from myself, the shadows where shame and fear have made their home. Shine into me. Expose what needs exposing. Heal what needs healing. Transform what needs transforming. And having received thy light, make me a bearer of light to others. Let me not hoard illumination but reflect it into every darkness I encounter this day, that others may see and glorify the Father in heaven. Amen

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Lighten our darkness, we beseech thee, O Lord; and by thy great mercy defend us from all perils and dangers of this night; for the love of thy only Son, our Saviour, Jesus Christ. And may the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE NINTH DAY

The Door

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, imagining yourself standing before a door, not a barrier to be overcome but an invitation to enter the Father's house.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from George Herbert:

Come, my Way, my Truth, my Life: such a Way as gives us breath; such a Truth as ends all strife; such a Life as killeth death. Come, my Light, my Feast, my Strength: such a Light as shows a feast; such a Feast as mends in length; such a Strength as makes his guest. Come, my Joy, my Love, my Heart: such a Joy as none can move; such a Love as none can part; such a Heart as joys in love. Open unto me the gates of righteousness, that I may enter in and praise the Lord.

Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has sought other doors:

O Lord, I confess that I have tried to enter life by many doors of my own choosing. I have climbed walls instead of using the gate. I have sought secret passages and back entrances. I have resented the narrowness of the one Door thou hast provided and complained that the way should be broader.

I confess too that I have sometimes stood before the Door and not entered, paralysed by fear of what I might find within, or by attachment to what I would leave without. Forgive my pride that would find another way. Forgive my fear that would remain outside. Draw me through the Door into the pasture of thy love. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The Door stands open. The Shepherd calls you by name. Your sins, which kept you wandering outside, are forgiven. Enter into the joy of your Master, into the pasture of his grace, into the household of God. You belong here. Welcome home. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 24:

The earth is the Lord's, and the fulness thereof;

the world, and they that dwell herein.

For he hath founded it upon the seas,

and established it upon the floods.

Who shall ascend into the hill of the Lord?

or who shall stand in his holy place?

He that hath clean hands, and a pure heart;

who hath not lifted up his soul unto vanity, nor sworn deceitfully.

He shall receive the blessing from the Lord,

and righteousness from the God of his salvation.

This is the generation of them that seek him,

that seek thy face, O Jacob.

Lift up your heads, O ye gates;

and be ye lift up, ye everlasting doors;

and the King of glory shall come in.

Who is this King of glory?

The Lord strong and mighty,

the Lord mighty in battle.

Lift up your heads, O ye gates;

even lift them up, ye everlasting doors;

and the King of glory shall come in.

Who is this King of glory?

The Lord of hosts, he is the King of glory.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Hear the Shepherd speak of the sheepfield:

John 10:7-10

Then said Jesus unto them again, Verily, Verily, I say unto you, I am the door of the sheep. All that ever came before me as thieves and robbers: but the sheep did not hear them. I am the door: by me if any man enter in, he shall be saved, and shall go in and out, and find pasture. The thief cometh not, but for to steal, and to kill, and to destroy: I am come that they might have life, and that they might have it more abundantly.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'I am the door.' In ancient Near Eastern shepherding, the shepherd would literally lie across the entrance of the sheepfold at night, becoming with his own body the door. Christ is not merely the means of access but the one who interposes himself between us and every threat.
2. 'He shall be saved, and shall go in and out, and find pasture.' The door provides both security and freedom, safety within, provision without. Notice the movement: not a prison where sheep are locked in, but a home from which they venture forth and to which they return.
3. 'Life, and that they might have it more abundantly.' The thief diminishes; the Door enlarges. Christ does not offer the bare minimum of survival but the overflowing fullness of true life. What abundance is he offering you that you have been afraid to receive?

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for entrance into God's presence:

Almighty God, unto whom all hearts are open, all desires known, and from whom no secrets are hid: Cleanse the thoughts of our hearts by the inspiration of thy Holy Spirit, that we may perfectly love thee, and worthily magnify thy holy Name; through Christ our Lord, who is the Door by which we enter boldly into thy presence. Grant us this day to go in and out and find pasture, and at the last to dwell in the house of the Lord forever. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those who seek entrance to God and those who feel excluded.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What other doors have you tried to enter life through? What keeps you from entering fully through Christ? What does abundant life look like for you this day?

Lord Jesus Christ, Door of the sheep: I have tried so many other entrances; the door of achievement, the door of approval, the door of accumulation, the door of avoidance. They have led only to smaller rooms. This day I enter through thee. I step across the threshold of thy body broken for me. I pass through the doorway of thy wounds. Within thy fold I find my safety; beyond thy door I find my service. Keep me from settling for survival when thou offerest abundance. Let me live this day the larger life for which thou hast made me. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Go forth into the world in peace. The Door is open behind you; you may always return. The pasture is before you; go and find nourishment. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE TENTH DAY

The Alpha and the Omega

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, placing yourself within the vast sweep of God's purposes, from creation's dawn to history's consummation, and recognising that this present moment is held within that eternal embrace.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from the Te Deum, the ancient hymn of the Church triumphant:

We praise thee, O God; we acknowledge thee to be the Lord. All the earth doth worship thee, the Father everlasting. To thee all Angels cry aloud, the Heavens and all the Powers therein. To thee Cherubim and Seraphim continually do cry: Holy, holy, Holy, Lord God of Sabaoth; Heaven and earth are full of the Majesty of thy glory. The glorious company of the Apostles praise thee. The goodly fellowship of the Prophets praise thee. The noble army of Martyrs praise thee. The holy Church throughout all the world doth acknowledge thee, the Father of an infinite Majesty, thine honourable, true, and only Son, also the Holy Ghost the Comforter. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has lived as though time had no Author or End:

Eternal God, before whom a thousand years are as a day and a day as a thousand years: I confess that I have lived as though my small span of time were the whole story. I have forgotten that thou art the Beginning from which all things come and the End toward which all things move. I have treated my moments as though they were my own possession rather than thy gift.

I have rushed through days without reverence for thy ordering of time. I have fretted over futures as though thou wert not already there. I have grieved over pasts as though thy redemption could not reach backward. Forgive my temporal arrogance. Teach me to number my days that I may gain a heart of wisdom. Through Jesus Christ, the Alpha and Omega. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The One who is the Beginning has begun a good work in you. The One who is the End will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ. Your sins; past, present, and future, are gathered into his forgiveness. From everlasting to everlasting, his mercy endures. Go in peace. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 90:1-6, 12-17:

Lord, thou hast been our dwelling place

in all generations.

Before the mountains were brought forth,

or ever thou hadst formed the earth and the world,

even from everlasting to everlasting, thou art God.

Thou turnest man to destruction;

and sayest, Return, ye children of men.

For a thousand years in thy sight

are but as yesterday when it is past,

and as a watch in the night.

Thou carriest them away as with a flood;

they are as a sleep:

in the morning they are like grass which groweth up.

In the morning it flourisheth, and groweth up;

in the evening it is cut down, and withereth.

So teach us to number our days,

that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom.

Return, O Lord, how long?

and let it repent thee concerning thy servants.

O satisfy us early with thy mercy;

that we may rejoice and be glad all our days.

Make us glad according to the days wherein thou hast afflicted us,

and the years wherein we have seen evil.

Let thy work appear unto thy servants,

and thy glory unto their children.

And let the beauty of the Lord our God be upon us:

and establish thou the work of our hands upon us;

yea, the work of our hands establish thou it.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the Eternal One:

Revelation 1:8; 21:5-6; 22:12-13

I am the Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the ending, saith the Lord, which is, and which was, and which is to come, the Almighty… And he that sat upon the throne said, Behold, I make all things new. And he said unto me, Write: for these words are true and faithful. And he said unto me, It is done. I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end. I will give unto him that is athirst of the fountain of the water of life freely… And, behold, I come quickly; and my reward is with me, to give every man according as his work shall be. I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end, the first and the last.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. ‘I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the ending.’ Christ encompasses all of time within himself. There is no moment of history; past or future, where he is not present and sovereign. The Beginning is not behind us and the End is not merely ahead of us; they are with us now in him.
2. ‘Behold, I make all things new.’ This is not merely future promise but present activity. Even now, in the midst of decay and death, the renewing work has begun. What in your life is Christ making new this day? What needs to be entrusted to his transforming power?
3. ‘I will give unto him that is athirst of the fountain of the water of life freely.’ The gift is free, already paid for, already offered, waiting only to be received. The Alpha has begun it; the Omega will complete it. All that is required is thirst and the willingness to drink.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending to its sweep from creation to judgement:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for trust in God's eternal purposes:

Almighty God, who art the Alpha and Omega, the Beginning and the End: Grant us so to pass through things temporal that we finally lose not the things eternal. Give us grace to live each day as those who know that thou holdest all our times in thy hand, that neither past regrets nor future fears may rob us of present peace. And at the last, when time shall be no more, bring us to the city which hath no need of sun or moon, for the Lamb is the light thereof; through the same Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those facing endings and those awaiting new beginnings.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: How does knowing Christ as Alpha and Omega change your relationship to time; to the presence of today, the regrets of yesterday, the anxieties of tomorrow?

Lord Jesus Christ, Alpha and Omega, First and Last, Beginning and End: I bring thee my disordered relationship with time. I bring the past I cannot release, the failures that haunt, the losses that grieve, the roads not taken that I still wonder about. I bring the future I cannot control; the outcomes I fear, the changes I resist, the mortality I deny. I bring the present I cannot fully inhabit, distracted by memory, anxious about tomorrow.

Thou who art the Lord of all ages, teach me to live this day as the gift it is. Let me neither flee into nostalgia nor escape into anticipation, but meet thee here, in this moment, which is the only place where thy eternal life intersects my temporal existence. For thou art the same yesterday, today, and forever. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Unto him who is the Alpha and Omega, the Beginning and the End, the First and the Last, be honour and glory, dominion and power, now and unto the ages of ages. And the blessing of God Almighty, who was, and is, and is to come, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE ELEVENTH DAY

The Lamb of God

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, allowing the image of the Lamb to settle in your imagination, not merely a symbol of gentleness, but the Lamb who conquers by being slain, who reigns from the throne of sacrifice.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray the Agnus Dei, the ancient hymn sung at the fraction of the bread:

O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us.

O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us.

O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, grant us thy peace.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one for whom the Lamb was slain:

Holy God, Holy and Mighty, Holy Immortal One: I come before thee not with the blood of bulls and goats, not with any sacrifice of my own making, but trusting only in the Lamb slain from the foundation of the world. I confess that my sins required such a sacrifice, not the blood of animals that could never truly cleanse, but the precious blood of Christ, a Lamb without blemish or spot.

Receive the absolution:

Behold the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world; including your sin, especially your sin. The blood of the Lamb speaks a better word than the blood of Abel; it speaks forgiveness, it speaks cleansing, it speaks peace. You are washed, you are sanctified, you are justified in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ. Go in peace. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray the Song of the Lamb from Revelation 15:3-4:

Great and marvellous are thy works,

Lord God Almighty;

just and true are thy ways,

thou King of saints.

Who shall not fear thee, O Lord,

and glorify thy Name?

For thou only art holy:

for all nations shall come and worship before thee;

for thy judgements are made manifest.

Continue with Psalm 113:

Praise ye the Lord.

Praise, O ye servants of the Lord,

praise the Name of the Lord.

Blessed be the Name of the Lord

from this time forth and for evermore.

From the rising of the sun unto the going down of the same

the Lord's Name is to be praised.

The Lord is high above all nations,

and his glory above the heavens.

Who is like unto the Lord our God,

who dwelleth on high,

who humbleth himself to behold

the things that are in heaven, and in the earth!

He raiseth up the poor out of the dust,

and lifteth the needy out of the dunghill;

That he may set him with princes,

even with the princes of his people.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the testimony of the Baptist and the vision of the Apocalypse:

John 1:29, 35-36; Revelation 5:6-10

The next day John seeth Jesus coming unto him, and saith, Behold the Lamb of God, which taketh away the sin of the world… Again the next day after John stood, and two of his disciples; And looking upon Jesus as he walked, he saith, Behold the Lamb of God!… And I behold, and lo, in the midst of the throne and of the four beasts, and in the midst of the elders, stood a Lamb as it had been slain, having seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven Spirits of God sent forth into all the earth. And he came and took the book out of the right hand of him that sat upon the throne. And when he had taken the book, the four beasts and four and twenty elders fell down before the Lamb… And they sung a new song, saying, Thou art worthy to take the book, and to open the seals thereof: for thou wast slain, and hast redeemed us to God by thy blood out of every kindred, and tongue, and people, and nation; And hast made us unto our God kings and priests: and we shall reign on the earth.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. John points twice: 'Behold the Lamb of God.' The repetition is not accidental. We need to be shown again and again. Our gaze wanderers to a thousand other objects; the Baptist's finger redirects us always to the Lamb. What is the Spirit pointing you toward this morning?

2. In Revelation, the Lamb stands 'as it had been slain,' bearing eternally the marks of sacrifice, yet standing, alive, victorious. Christ's wounds are not erased in glory but transfigured. His scars are his credentials, his authority, his beauty.
3. The Lamb has made us 'kings and priests.' The sacrifice of Christ is not merely for our pardon but for our transformation. We who were slaves are now royalty; we who were unclean are now ministers of the sanctuary. What priestly service does the Lamb call you to this day?

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending to its sweep from creation to judgement:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive

those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect in honour of the Lamb:

Almighty God, whose most dear Son went not up to joy but first he suffered pain, and entered not into glory before he was crucified: Mercifully grant that we, walking in the way of the cross, may find it none other than the way of life and peace; through the same thy Son Jesus Christ our Lord, the Lamb slain from the foundation of the world, who liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those who suffer innocently and those burdened by guilt.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: How does the image of the slain-yet-standing Lamb shape your understanding of power, of victory, of how God works in the world? How might you embody lamb-like power this day?

Lord Jesus Christ, Lamb of God: I marvel that thou dost conquer not by force but by sacrifice, not by violence but by vulnerability, not by grasping but by giving. Teach me this strange victory. When I am tempted to assert myself by worldly power, remind me of the Lamb. When I am tempted to protect myself by aggression, remind me of the Lamb. When I am tempted to advance myself by manipulation, remind me of the Lamb. Let me follow thee in the way of redemptive suffering, trusting that what looks like defeat is the very shape of triumph. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Worthy is the Lamb that was slain to receive power, and riches, and wisdom, and strength, and honour, and glory, and blessing. To him who sits on the throne and to the Lamb be blessing and honour and glory and might forever and ever. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE TWELFTH DAY

The Great High Priest

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware that at this very moment, Christ your High Priest stands in the heavenly sanctuary, interceding for you by name before the Father's throne.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from the Letter to the Hebrews:

O God, who hast given us a great High Priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus, the Son of God: Grant that we may hold fast our confession. For we have not a high priest who is unable to sympathise with our weaknesses, but one who in every respect has been tempted as we are, yet without sin. Let us then with confidence draw near the throne of grace, that we may receive mercy and find grace to help in time of need. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has access to the Holy of Holies through Christ:

Almighty and everlasting God, I confess that I have lived as though I needed to make my own way into thy presence; as though the veil were still intact, as though I must earn access to thy throne. I have brought thee my own inadequate offerings: my good works tainted by pride, my prayers distracted by self-interest, my worship mixed with performance.

Yet thou hast provided a better sacrifice and perfect Priest. Christ has entered once for all into the holy places, not by the blood of goats and calves but by means of his own blood, thus securing an eternal redemption. Forgive my self-reliant religion. Teach me to rest in his finished work, to come boldly through the torn veil, to trust his intercession rather than my own merit. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

Your High Priest has heard your confession and presents it, purified, before the Father. By his one offering he has perfected for all time those who are being sanctified. Your sins and lawless deeds he remembers no more. Where there is forgiveness of these, there is no longer any offering for sin. You are forgiven; draw near with a true heart in full assurance of faith. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 110, the royal psalm of Christ's priesthood:

The Lord said unto my Lord,

Sit thou at my right hand,

until I make thine enemies thy footstool.

The Lord shall send the rod of thy strength out of Zion:

rule thou in the midst of thine enemies.

Thy people shall be willing in the day of thy power,

in the beauties of holiness from the womb of the morning:

thou hast the dew of thy youth.

The Lord hath sworn, and will not repent,

Thou art a priest for ever

after the order of Melchizedek.

The Lord at thy right hand

shall strike through kings in the day of his wrath.

He shall judge among the heathen,

he shall fill the places with the dead bodies;

he shall wound the heads over many countries.

He shall drink of the brook in the way:

therefore shall he lift up the head.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word concerning Christ's heavenly ministry:

Hebrews 4:14-16; 7:23-27

Seeing then that we have a great high priest, that is passed into the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our profession. For we have not an high priest which cannot be touched with the feeling of our infirmities; but was in all points tempted like as we are, yet without sin. Let us therefore come boldly unto the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy, and find grace to help in time of need... And they truly were many priests, because they were not suffered to continue by reason of death: But this man, because he continueth ever, hath an unchangeable priesthood. Wherefore he is able also to save them to the uttermost that come unto God by him, seeing he ever liveth to make intercession for them. For such an high priest became us, who is holy, harmless, undefiled, separate from sinners, and made higher than the heavens; Who needeth not daily, as those high priests, to offer up sacrifice, first for his own sins, and then for the people's: for this he did once, when he offered up himself.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'Touched with the feeling of our infirmities.' The High Priest in the heavenly sanctuary is not remote from your struggles. He has worn your flesh, faced your temptations, known your weariness. His sympathy is not theoretical but experiential. He knows.
2. 'He ever liveth to make intercession.' At this very moment, as you pray, Christ is praying for you. Your halting words are caught up into his perfect prayer. Your needs, even those you cannot articulate, are being presented before the Father by one who loves you more than you love yourself.
3. 'Able to save them to the uttermost.' Not partially, not provisionally, not with reservations; but completely, finally, eternally. Whatever pit you have fallen into, whatever depth you have sunk to, the arm of the High

Priest reaches deeper still. No uttermost is beyond his saving.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for confidence in Christ's intercession:

O God, who through thy Son Jesus Christ hast consecrated for us a new and living way into the holiest of all: Grant that we, having access to thy presence by faith in him, may continually offer unto

thee sacrifices of praise and thanksgiving, and present ourselves a living sacrifice, holy acceptable unto thee; through the same Jesus Christ our Lord, who liveth and reigneth with thee in the unity of the Holy Spirit, one God, now and for ever. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, trusting that Christ joins his prayers to yours.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: How does knowing that Christ intercedes for you change the way you pray? The way you approach failure? The way you face this day's challenges?

Lord Jesus Christ, Great High Priest: I marvel that thou dost not merely hear my prayers but perfect them; that thou dost not merely forgive my sins that plead for me; that thou dost not merely save me and leave me but continuest ever to minister on my behalf. This day, let me live in the confidence of thy intercession. When I feel alone, remind me that thou art praying. When I feel unworthy, remind me that thy worthiness is enough. When I feel that my prayers are too small or too scattered, remind me that they are gathered into thy great prayer and presented before the Father. I rest in thee, my Priest forever. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Now unto him that is able to keep you from falling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory with exceeding joy, to the only wise God our Saviour through Jesus Christ our Great High Priest, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and ever. Amen.

THE THIRTEENTH DAY

The King of Kings

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, acknowledging that you stand in the presence of the supreme Sovereign; not a distant monarch but a King who has knelt to wash his servants' feet.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from the Accession Service of the Book of Common Prayer:

O God, who providest for thy people by thy power, and rulest over them in love: Grant unto thy servant our King the Spirit of wisdom and government, that being devoted unto thee with all this heart, he may so wisely govern, that in his time thy Church and people may enjoy wealth, peace, and godliness. But above all earthly kings, we acknowledge thee, Lord Christ, to be King of kings and Lord of lords, to whom every knee shall bow and every tongue confess. Reign in our hearts this day and forever. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has been disloyal to the true King:

O King eternal, immortal, invisible: I confess that I have been an unfaithful subject of thy kingdom. I have served other lords; the lords of comfort, of reputation, of security. I have given my allegiance to rival sovereigns and divided my loyalty among competing claims. I have acted as though I were my own king, as though my will were supreme, as though I answered to no one.

Yet thou art the King of kings, before whom all earthly power are as dust. Forgive my treason. Restore me to thy service. Teach me the freedom that comes from glad surrender to thy gracious reign. Through Jesus Christ, to whom all authority in heaven and earth has been given. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The King has heard your confession and pronounces pardon. Your rebellion is forgiven. Your treason is covered by royal mercy. Rise, not as a condemned traitor but as a beloved child of the King, an heir of the kingdom, a citizen of the realm that shall have no end. Go in peace, and serve the King with gladness. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 72:1-8, 17-19, the psalm of the righteous King:

Give the king thy judgements, O God,

and thy righteousness unto the king's son.

He shall judge thy people with righteousness,

and thy poor with judgement.

The mountains shall bring peace to the people,

and the little hills, by righteousness.

He shall judge the poor of the people,

he shall save the children of the needy,

and shall break in pieces the oppressor.

They shall fear thee as long as the sun and moon endure,

throughout all generations.

He shall come down like rain upon the mown grass:

as showers that water the earth.

In his days shall the righteous flourish;

and abundance of peace so long as the moon endureth.

He shall have dominion also from sea to sea,

and from the river unto the ends of the earth.

His name shall endure for ever:

his name shall be continued as long as the sun:

and men shall be blessed in him:

all nations shall call him blessed.

Blessed be the Lord God, the God of Israel,

who only doeth wondrous things.

And blessed be his glorious Name for ever:

and let the whole earth be filled with his glory;

Amen, and Amen.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the coming King:

Revelation 19:11-16

And I saw heaven opened, and behold a white horse; and he that sat upon him was called Faithful and True, and in righteousness he doth judge and make war. His eyes were as a flame of fire, and on his head were many crowns; and he had a name written, that no man knew, but he himself. And he was clothed with a vesture dipped in blood: and his name is called The Word of God. And the armies which were in heaven followed him upon white horses, clothed in fine linen, white and clean. And out of his mouth goeth a sharp sword, that with it he should smite the nations: and he shall rule them with a rod of iron: and he treadeth the winepress of the fierceness and wrath of Almighty God. And he hath on his vesture and on his thigh a name written, KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'Faithful and True.' The King's first titles are not about power but about character. Before he is mighty, he is trustworthy. Before he conquers, he keeps his word. His

reign is grounded not in force alone but in unfailing fidelity. Can you trust such a King with your life?

2. 'A vesture dipped in blood.' The King comes not in pristine splendour but marked by sacrifice. This is the same Lamb who was slain, now revealed as conquering King. His authority to rule flows from his willingness to serve, to suffer, to die. This is the pattern of his kingdom.
3. 'KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS.' Every earthly power, every human authority, every principality and dominion is subordinate to this King. The rulers you fear, the systems that oppress, the forces that seem invincible; all will bow before him. What would change if you truly believed this?

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for the King's reign:

Almighty and everlasting God, whose will it is to restore all things in thy well-beloved Son, the King of kings and Lord of lords: Mercifully grant that the peoples of the earth, divided and enslaved by sin, may be freed and brought together under his most gracious rule; who liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and for ever. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those who exercise authority and those who suffer under unjust rule.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What rival kings demand your allegiance? What areas of your life have you withheld from Christ's reign? How might you live as a citizen of his kingdom this day?

Lord Jesus Christ, King of Kings and Lord of lords; I acknowledge thy rightful sovereignty over every corner of my life. I have withheld territory from thy rule; my ambitions, my finances, my relationships, my secret thoughts. This day I surrender the keys. Take the throne of my heart. Govern my choices. Direct my steps. Let thy kingdom come and thy will be done in me, even as it is done in heaven. And when lesser kings demand my worship, give me courage to say: I have but one King, and him only will I serve. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Now unto the King eternal, immortal, invisible, the only wise God, be honour and glory for ever and ever. And the blessing of him who is King of kings and Lord of lords, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE FOURTEENTH DAY

The Bridegroom

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, allowing yourself to be loved; not as a servant to master, not as subject to king, but as bride to bridegroom, as beloved to lover.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from Bernard of Clairvaux:

Jesus, thou Joy of loving hearts, thou Fount of life, thou Light of men, from the best bliss that earth imparts we turn unfilled to thee again. We taste thee, O thou living Bread, and long to feast upon thee still; we drink of thee, the Fountainhead, and thirst our souls from thee to fill. Come, Bridegroom of the Church, and visit us with thy salvation. Reveal thyself to our waiting hearts, that we may know the love that surpasses knowledge. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has been unfaithful to the Bridegroom.

O God, whose Son is the Bridegroom of the Church: I confess that I have played the harlot with other lovers. I have given my heart to things that cannot satisfy, my affection to idols that cannot love me back. I have forgotten my first love. I have grown cold in devotion. I have treated the Bridegroom as a mere acquaintance rather than the lover of my soul.

Yet thy love is unfailing. Even when I have been faithless, thou hast remained faithful. Even when I have wandered, thou hast pursued. Forgive my adulteries of the heart. Renew in me the joy of our betrothal. Restore to me the glad anticipation of the wedding feast. Through Jesus Christ, the Bridegroom who gave himself for his bride. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The Bridegroom rejoices over you as a bridegroom rejoices over his bride. Your unfaithfulness is forgiven; your wandering is pardoned; your coldness is met with inexhaustible warmth. He who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ. You are betrothed to one husband, to present you as a pure virgin to Christ. Go in peace, beloved of the Lord. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 45:1-2, 6-9, the wedding psalm of the King:

My heart is inditing a good matter:

I speak of the things which I have made touching the king:

my tongue is the pen of a ready writer.

Thou art fairer than the children of men:

grace is poured into thy lips:

therefore God hath blessed thee for ever.

Thy throne, O God, is for ever and ever:

the sceptre of thy kingdom is a right sceptre.

Thou lovest righteousness, and hatest wickedness:

therefore God, thy God, hath anointed thee

with the oil of gladness above thy fellows.

All thy garments smell of myrrh, and aloes, and cassia,

out of the ivory palaces,

whereby they have made thee glad.

Kings' daughters were among thy honourable women:

upon thy right hand did stand the queen in gold of Ophir.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the Bridegroom's love:

Ephesians 5:25-27, 31-32; Revelation 19:7-9

Husbands, love your wives, even as Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it; That he might sanctify and cleanse it with the washing of water by the word, That he might present it to himself a

glorious church, not having spot, or wrinkle, or any such thing; but that it should be holy and without blemish… For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall be joined unto his wife, and they two shall be one flesh. This is a great mystery: but I speak concerning Christ and the church… Let us be glad and rejoice, and give honour to him: for the marriage of the Lamb is come, and his wife hath made herself ready. And to her was granted that she should be arrayed in fine linen, clean and white: for the fine linen is the righteousness of saints. And he saith unto me, Write, Blessed are they which are called unto the marriage supper of the Lamb.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'Christ loved the church and gave himself for it.' The Bridegroom's love is not mere sentiment but sacrifice. He did not wait until the bride was worthy; he made her worthy by his giving. His love is not response to beauty but the source of beauty.
2. 'That he might present it to himself a glorious church.' The Bridegroom is preparing his bride; washing, sanctifying, removing every spot and wrinkle. The trials of this life are part of the bridal preparation. He is making you ready for the wedding day.
3. 'Blessed are they which are called unto the marriage supper of the Lamb.' The great feast awaits. All of history moves toward this wedding celebration. Every Eucharist is a foretaste, every Lord's Day a rehearsal. You are invited; your place at the table is reserved.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for love of Christ:

O God, who hast prepared for them that love thee such good things as pass man's understanding: Pour into our hearts such love toward thee, that we, loving thee above all things, may obtain thy promises, which exceed all that we can desire. Grant that the love of thy Son, our Bridegroom, may so captivate our hearts that all other loves may find their proper place within that great love; through Jesus Christ our Lord, who liveth and reigneth with thee in the unity of the Holy Spirit, one God, world without end. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for marriages, for the Church, and for those who long for love.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What does it mean to be loved by Christ as a bridegroom loves his bride? What would change if you truly believed in and received this love?

Lord Jesus Christ, Bridegroom of my soul: I confess that I do not often think of thee in such intimate terms. I am more comfortable with thee as teacher or master or even king than as lover. Yet thou hast chosen this image to describe thy passion for thy people. Teach me to receive love, not merely duty. Awaken in me a longing for thee that goes beyond obligation to desire. Let me hear thee say, 'Arise, my love, my fair one, and come away' And give me grace to follow, leaving behind the lesser loves that have held me captive, until at last I feast with thee at the marriage supper of the Lamb. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.

℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

The love of Christ, which surpasses knowledge, fill your hearts with all the fullness of God. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father who chose you, the Son who loves you, and the Holy Spirit who seals you for the day of redemption, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE FIFTEENTH DAY

The Cornerstone

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware that your life is not a solitary structure but a stone being fitted into a building; a temple being raised by God himself, with Christ as the foundation and cornerstone.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from the consecration of churches:

O Almighty God, who hast built thy Church upon the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ himself being the chief cornerstone: Grant us so to be joined together in unity of spirit by their doctrine, that we may be made a holy temple acceptable unto thee; through Jesus Christ our Lord, who liveth and reigneth with thee in the unity of the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has built on faulty foundations:

Almighty God, I confess that I have tried to build my life on foundations other than Christ. I have laid the cornerstone of my own achievements, my own reputation, my own security. I have constructed elaborate structures that do not rest on the solid rock but on shifting sand.

I confess too that I have resisted being built into thy temple. I have preferred to remain a solitary stone rather than be fitted together with others in thy Church. I have rejected the shaping and cutting that would make fit for thy building.

Forgive my faulty construction. Demolish what cannot stand. Lay me afresh upon the true foundation, and build me with others into a dwelling place for thy Spirit. Through Jesus Christ, the Cornerstone. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The stone that the builders rejected has become the cornerstone. Upon this sure foundation your life is now established. What was built on sand has been swept away; what remains is built on rock. You are forgiven, you are restored, you are being built into a spiritual house, to offer spiritual sacrifices acceptable to God through Jesus Christ. Go in peace. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 118:19-29:

Open to me the gates of righteousness:

I will go into them, and I will praise the Lord:

This gate of the Lord,

into which the righteous shall enter.

I will praise thee: for thou hast heard me,

and art become my salvation.

The stone which the builders refused

is become the head stone of the corner.

This is the Lord's doing;

it is marvellous in our eyes.

This is the day which the Lord hath made;

we will rejoice and be glad in it.

Save now, I beseech thee, O Lord:

O Lord, I beseech thee, send now prosperity.

Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord;

we have blessed you out of the house of the Lord.

God is the Lord, which hath shewed us light:

bind the sacrifice with cords,

even unto the horns of the altar.

Thou art my God, and I will praise thee:

thou art my God, I will exalt thee.

O give thanks unto the Lord; for he is good:

for his mercy endureth for ever.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of Christ the Cornerstone:

Ephesians 2:19-22; 1 Peter 2:4-6

Now therefore ye are no more strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints, and of the household of God; And are built upon the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ himself being the chief corner stone; In whom all the building fitly framed together groweth unto an holy temple in the Lord: In whom ye also are builded together for an habitation of God through the Spirit... To whom coming, as unto a living stone, disallowed indeed of men, but chosen of God, and precious, Ye also, as lively stones, are built up a spiritual house, an holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices, acceptable to God by Jesus Christ. Wherefore also it is contained in the scripture, Behold, I lay in Sion a chief corner stone, elect, precious: and he that believeth on him shall not be confounded.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'The stone which the builders refused is become the head stone of the corner.' What the world rejected, God chose. What seemed weakness was strength. What appeared failure was victory. The Cornerstone was laid in a manger and cemented with blood on a cross. God's building methods are not ours.

2. ‘Ye also, as lively stones, are built up a spiritual house.’ You are not merely building your own life; you are being built into something larger. The Christian faith is not a private spirituality but a corporate project. Your stone is needed in the wall; your absence would leave a gap.
3. ‘In whom all the building fitly framed together groweth unto an holy temple.’ The building is still under construction. The temple is growing. What seems like chaos and scaffolding is actually careful construction. The Architect knows what he is doing, even when you cannot see the blueprints.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending to the article on the Church:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us

this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for the Church:

O Almighty and everlasting God, who in Christ hast revealed thy glory among the nations: Preserve the works of thy mercy, that thy Church throughout the world may persevere with steadfast faith in the confession of thy Name; through Jesus Christ our Lord, who is the chief Cornerstone, in whom the whole structure is joined together and grows into a holy temple in the Lord. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for the unity of the Church and for your local congregation.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: How are you being fitted into God's building? What shaping or cutting is needed for you to fit properly? How is God calling you to contribute to the building of his temple?

Lord Jesus Christ, Cornerstone of the Church: I have too often acted as though my faith were a private possession, a solitary structure, a single stone standing alone. Forgive my individualism. Fit me into thy building. Shape me to rest against my brothers and sisters. Cut away whatever prevents proper joining.

And help me to be a builder with thee; laying stones of encouragement, mixing mortar of prayer, lifting others into their proper place. For we are not building our own monuments but thy temple, a dwelling place for thy Spirit in the world. Let thy Church be built in me and through me this day. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May Christ, the Cornerstone, establish you in faith; may the Spirit, the Builder, fit you together in love; and may the Father, the Architect, bring his temple to glorious completion. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE SIXTEENTH DAY

The Morning Star

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. If it is still dark outside, consider the particular grace of this image; Christ as the star that announces the dawn, the light that shines before the sun rises. Keep one minute of silence, allowing hope to stir in whatever darkness you carry.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from the ancient O Antiphons of Advent:

O Morning Star, Splendour of the Light Eternal and bright Sun of Righteousness: come and enlighten those who sit in darkness and in shadow of death. Thou who art the Dayspring from on high, visit us with thy tender mercy, to guide our feet into the way of peace. O come, thou Dayspring, come and cheer our spirits by thine advent here; disperse the gloomy clouds of night, and death's dark shadows put to flight. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has preferred darkness to the approaching dawn:

O God, who hast sent thy Son as the Morning Star to herald the dawn of thy kingdom: I confess that I have loved the darkness. I have grown comfortable in the night. I have preferred the shadows where my deeds could not be seen, where my face could not be read, where I could hide from thee and from myself.

I confess too that I have despaired of the dawn. I have looked at the darkness around me and within me and concluded that the night would never end. I have forgotten that thou art faithful, that weeping may endure for a night but joy cometh in the morning.

Forgive my love of darkness. Forgive my despair of dawn. Let the Morning Star rise in my heart, bringing the promise of a day that shall never end. Through Jesus Christ, the Light that shines in the darkness. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The darkness is passing away, and the true light is already shining. The Morning Star has risen upon you. Your sins, which belong to the night, are forgiven. Walk now as a child of the day, for you are not of the night or of darkness. The dawn has come; go in peace. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray the Benedictus, the song of Zechariah at the dawn of salvation:

Blessed be the Lord God of Israel;

for he hath visited and redeemed his people;

And hath raised up a mighty salvation for us,

in the house of his servant David;

As he spake by the mouth of his holy Prophets,

which have been since the world began;

That we should be saved from our enemies,

and from the hand of all that hate us.

To perform the mercy promised to our forefathers,

and to remember his holy Covenant;

To perform the oath which he sware to our forefather Abraham,

that he would give us;

That we being delivered out of the hand of our enemies

might serve him without fear;

In holiness and righteousness before him,

all the days of our life.

And thou, Child, shalt be called the Prophet of the Highest:

for thou shalt go before the face of the Lord to prepare his ways;

To give knowledge of salvation unto his people

for the remission of their sins,

Through the tender mercy of our God;

whereby the Dayspring from on high hath visited us;

To give light to them that sit in darkness, and in the shadow of death,

and to guide our feet into the way of peace.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the promise of the Morning Star:

2 Peter 1:16-19; Revelation 22:16

For we have not followed cunningly devised fables, when we made known unto you the power and coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, but were eyewitnesses of his majesty. For he received from God the Father honour and glory, when there came such a voice to him from the excellent glory, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased. And this voice which came from heaven we heard, when we were with him in the holy mount. We have also a more sure word of prophecy; whereunto ye do well that ye take heed, as unto a light that shineth in a dark place, until the day dawn, and the day star arise in your hearts... I Jesus have sent mine angel to testify unto you these things in the churches. I am the root and the offspring of David, and the bright and morning star.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. The morning star appears when the night is darkest, just before the dawn. It does not dispel that darkness by itself, but it promises that the sun is coming. Christ's presence in your darkness is not yet the fullness of day, but it is the sure sign that day is approaching.
2. 'Until the day dawn, and the day star arise in your hearts.' The Morning Star is not only an objective reality in history but a subjective experience in the soul. Have you felt the

stirring of hope, the first light of faith, the intimation that the long night will not last forever? That is the Morning Star rising within.

3. 'I am the root and the offspring of David.' Christ is both the source of the ancient promises and their fulfilment. He is not merely the end of Israel's story but its beginning. Every prophecy, every hope every longing finds its origin and completion in him.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but

deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for hope in darkness:

O God, who makest us glad with the yearly remembrance of the birth of thine only Son Jesus Christ: Grant that as we joyfully receive him for our Redeemer, so we may with sure confidence behold him when he shall come to be our Judge; who liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, world without end. And until that day, let the Morning Star rise in our hearts, that we may walk as children of light even while the darkness lingers. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those in darkness of any kind; grief, depression, doubt, or despair.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: Where is your life does it feel like night? What darkness tempts you to despair? How might the presence of the Morning Star change your relationship to that darkness?

Lord Jesus Christ, bright Morning Star: I bring thee the darknesses of my life; the griefs that linger, the fears that multiply in the night watches, the sins that shame me when I am alone. I do not ask that thou wouldst instantly dispel them all, for I know that dawn comes gradually. But rise in my heart as the sure promise of coming day. Let me see thy light on the horizon and take courage. Let me know that the night, however long, is not forever, And when at last the full day breaks, let me find that I have been walking toward thee all along, guided by thy light through the darkness. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May the Dayspring from on high visit you, to give light to you who sit in darkness and in the shadow of death, and to guide your feet into the way of peace. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE SEVENTEENTH DAY

The Suffering Servant

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware of the One who was acquainted with grief, who carried your sorrows, who was wounded for your transgressions; not as distant historical fact but as present, living reality.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from the Good Friday liturgy:

Almighty God, we beseech thee graciously to behold this thy family, for which our Lord Jesus Christ was contented to be betrayed, and given up into the hands of wicked men, and to suffer death upon the cross; who now liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever. Look upon the face of thine Anointed, and meet us in the hour with the grace that flows from his sufferings. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one whose sins were borne by the Servant:

O God, whose Son took upon himself the form of a servant and was obedient even unto death: I confess that I have not followed his example. I have grasped at status rather than embraced humility. I have avoided suffering rather than accepted it redemptively. I have demanded to be served rather than offering service.

I confess that my sins contributed to his suffering. It was my transgressions that wounded him, my iniquities that bruised him. I cannot stand at the foot of the cross as an innocent spectator; I stand there as one whose guilt nailed him to the tree.

Yet by his stripes I am healed. By his wounds I am made whole. Accept my confession, and apply to me the benefits of his passion. Through the same Jesus Christ the Suffering Servant. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

He was wounded for your transgressions, he was buried for your iniquities; the chastisement of your peace was upon him, and by his stripes you are healed. All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned every one to his own way; and the Lord hath laid on him the iniquity of us all. Your iniquity is taken away. Your sin is purged. Go in peace. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 22:1-11, the psalm of the suffering Messiah:

My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?

why art thou so far from helping me,

and from the words of my roaring?

O my God, I cry in the daytime, but thou hearest not;

and in the night season, and am not silent.

But thou art holy,

O thou that inhabitest the praises of Israel.

Our fathers trusted in thee:

they trusted, and thou didst deliver them.

They cried unto thee, and were delivered:

they trusted in thee, and were not confounded.

But I am a worm, and no man;

a reproach of men, and despised of the people.

All they that see me laugh me to scorn:

they shoot out the lip, they shake the head, saying,

He trusted on the Lord that he would deliver him:

let him deliver him, seeing he delighted in him.

But thou art he that took me out of the womb:

thou didst make me hope when I was upon my mother's breasts.

I was cast upon thee from the womb:

thou art my God from my mother's belly.

Be not far from me; for trouble is near;

for there is none to help.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the Suffering Servant:

Isaiah 53:3-7, 10-11

He is despised and rejected of men; a man of sorrows, and acquainted with grief: and we hid as it were our faces from him; he was despised, and we esteemed him not. Surely he hath borne our griefs, and carried our sorrows: yet we did esteem him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted. But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace was upon him; and with his stripes we are healed. All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned every one to his own way; and the Lord hath laid on him the iniquity of us all. He was oppressed, and he was afflicted, yet he opened not his mouth: he is brought as a lamb to the slaughter, and as a sheep before her shearers is dumb, so he openeth not his mouth... Yet it pleased the Lord to bruise him; he hath put him to grief: when thou shalt make his soul an offering for sin, he shall see his seed, he shall prolong his days, and the pleasure of the Lord shall prosper in his hand. He shall see the travail of his soul, and shall be satisfied: by his knowledge shall my righteous servant justify many; for he shall bear their iniquities.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'A man of sorrows, and acquainted with grief.' Jesus did not merely observe human suffering from a divine distance; he entered into it fully. He knows your grief not

theoretically but experientially. When you suffer, you suffer with One who has suffered before you and alongside you.

2. 'He opened not his mouth.' The Servant's silence is not passive resignation but active self-offering. He does not protest, not because he cannot speak but because he chooses to bear what is laid upon him. His silence is eloquent with love.
3. 'He shall see of the travail of his soul and shall be satisfied.' The suffering was not in vain. The Servant sees the fruit of his anguish; a people redeemed, sins forgiven, enemies reconciled; and counts it worth the cost. You are the joy set before him for which he endured the cross.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending especially to the words 'suffered under Pontius Pilate.'

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect from the Passiontide liturgy:

Almighty and everlasting God, who of thy tender love towards mankind, hast sent thy Son our Saviour Jesus Christ to take upon him our flesh, and to suffer death upon the cross, that all mankind should follow the example of his great humility: Mercifully grant that we may both follow the example of his patience, and also be made partakers of his resurrection; through the same Jesus Christ our Lord, who liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those who suffer unjustly and those who bear others' burdens.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: How does the suffering of Christ sanctify your own suffering? How might you enter into fellowship with his sufferings this day? What burdens might you bear for others?

Lord Jesus Christ, Suffering Servant: I stand in awe of thy willingness to bear what should have been mine to bear. Thou wast not obligated; thou wast not compelled; thou didst choose to carry my griefs and sorrows. Teach me the mystery of redemptive suffering. When I cannot avoid pain, help me to offer it in union with thine. When others wound me, help me to forgive as thou didst forgive. When I see others suffering, help me to bear their burdens as thou hast borne mine. Let me not waste my sufferings but unite

them to thy cross, that they may become, in thy hands, instruments of grace. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May Christ, the Suffering Servant, who bore your griefs and carried your sorrows, grant you grace to bear one another's burdens and so fulfil his law of love. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE EIGHTEENTH DAY

The Second Adam

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, pondering the mystery that is Christ, humanity has been remade; that what Adam lost, Christ has restored; that what was broken in Eden is being mended in the new creation.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from Irenaeus of Lyon:

O God, whose Son Jesus Christ recapitulated in himself the long history of mankind, summing up and sanctifying all things from the beginning: Grant that what was lost in the first Adam may be found in the Second; that our fallen nature may be raised in him who descended to lift us up; and that we who bear the image of the man of dust may also bear the image of the man of heaven. Through the same Jesus Christ, the Second Adam, who liveth and reigneth with thee in the unity of the Holy Spirit, one God, world without end. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has inherited Adam's failure:

Almighty God, who didst create our first parents in thine own image and set them in paradise to enjoy thy presence: I confess that I have continued Adam's rebellion. I have reached for what was forbidden. I have hidden from thee in shame. I have blamed others for my sin. I have been exiled from the garden by my own choosing.

I bear in my flesh the marks of the fall; the proneness to sin, the fear of death, the restless striving after what cannot satisfy. I have lived as the child of Adam rather than as one reborn in Christ.

Yet in Christ, the Second Adam, thou hast begun again. In him, humanity has obeyed where Adam disobeyed, trusted where Adam doubted, loved where Adam grasped. Graft me into this new humanity. Let me die with the first Adam and rise with the Second. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

As in Adam all die, so in Christ shall all be made alive. You who were dead in trespass and sins have been made alive together with Christ. The old has passed away; behold, the new has come. You are a new creation; your sins are forgiven. Walk now in newness of life. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 8, the psalm of humanity's dignity and calling:

O Lord our Lord,

how excellent is thy Name in all the earth!

who hast set thy glory above the heavens.

Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings

hast thou ordained strength because of thine enemies,

that thou mightest still the enemy and the avenger.

When I consider thy heavens, the work of thy fingers,

the moon and the stars, which thou hast ordained;

What is man, that thou art mindful of him?

and the son of man, that thou visitest him?

For thou hast made him a little lower than the angels,

and hast crowned him with glory and honour.

Thou madest him to have dominion over the works of thy hands;

thou hast put all things under his feet:

All sheep and oxen,

yea, and the beasts of the field;

The fowl of the air, and the fish of the sea,

and whatsoever passeth through the paths of the seas.

O Lord our Lord,

how excellent is thy Name in all the earth!

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the two Adams:

Romans 5:17-19; 1 Corinthians 15:21-22, 45-49

For if by one man's offence death reigned by one; much more they which receive abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness shall reign in life by one, Jesus Christ. Therefore as by the offence of one judgement came upon all men to condemnation; even so by the righteousness of one the free gift came upon all men unto justification of life. For as by one man's disobedience many were made sinners, so by the obedience of one shall many be made righteous... For since by man came death, by man came also the resurrection of the dead. For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive... And so it is written, The first man Adam was made a living soul; the last Adam was made a quickening spirit. Howbeit that was not first which is spiritual, but that which is natural; and afterward that which is spiritual. The first man is of the earth, earthy: the second man is the Lord from heaven. As is the earthy, such are they also that are earthy: and as is the heavenly, such are they also that are heavenly. And as we have borne the image of the earthy, we shall also bear the image of the heavenly.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'By the obedience of one shall many be made righteous.' Adam's disobedience was not merely personal failure but racial catastrophe; his choice implicated all who came after him. So too Christ's obedience is not merely personal virtue but racial restoration. In him, humanity has finally said yes to God.
2. 'The first man Adam was made a living soul; the last Adam was made a quickening spirit.' The first Adam received life;

the Second Adam gives life. The progression is not merely from failure to success but from one mode of existence to another; from natural to spiritual, from mortal to immortal.

3. 'As we have borne the image of the earthly, we shall also bear the image of the heavenly.' You have spent your life wearing Adam's image; marked by his mortality, subject to his weaknesses. But another image is being formed in you. The process is not complete, but it is underway. You are becoming what Christ already is.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive

those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for new creation:

O God, who wonderfully created, and yet more wonderfully restored, the dignity of human nature: Grant that we may share the divine life of him who humbled himself to share our humanity, thy Son Jesus Christ our Lord, the Second Adam; who liveth and reigneth with thee, in the unity of the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for the renewal of all things and the healing of human brokenness.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: In what ways do you still live as a child of the first Adam? What would it mean to live this day as one united to the Second Adam; sharing his obedience, his trust, his love?

Lord Jesus Christ, Second Adam and head of the new humanity: I have lived too long in the shadow of the first Adam. I have accepted his legacy of fear, of grasping, of blame, of hiding. This day, I choose to live as one grafted into thee. Where Adam disobeyed, let me obey in thy strength. Where Adam doubted, let me trust by thy grace. Where Adam hid, let me come into the light of thy presence. Form in me thy image, that I may at last become what I was always meant to be; not merely a child of Adam but a brother of Christ, bearing the image of the man of heaven. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May Christ, the Second Adam, renew in you the image of God; may he undo in you the works of the first Adam; and may he bring you at last to the paradise from which our first parents were exiled. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE NINETEENTH DAY

The Friend of Sinners

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, allowing yourself to be welcomed; not as one who has earned a place at the table, but as one invited despite everything, because the Host delights in welcoming the unworthy.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from Charles Wesley:

Jesus! the name that charms our fears, that bids our sorrows cease; 'tis music in the sinner's ears, 'tis life, and health, and peace. He breaks the power of cancelled sin, he sets the prisoners free; his blood can make the foulest clean; his blood availed for me. Come, Friend of sinners, and sit with us at the table of thy grace. We have no righteousness to offer, no merit to present; we come because thou hast called us, and thy welcome is enough. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one welcomed despite unworthiness:

O Lord Jesus Christ, who wast called a friend of publicans and sinners: I confess that I am among those sinners whom thou hast befriended. I have not merited thy friendship. I have betrayed it, neglected it, taken it for granted. I have acted as though I deserved thy company, when in truth I deserve only thy judgement.

I confess too that I have withheld from others the welcome thou hast extended to me. I have drawn lines where thou hast drawn none. I have refused tables to those whom thou wouldst gladly seat beside me. I have been scandalised by the company thou keepst, forgetting that I am the scandal.

Forgive me, Friend of sinners, and welcome me again to thy table. Teach me to welcome others as thou hast welcomed me. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The Friend of sinners welcomes you. He does not wait for you to become worthy; he receives you as you are. Your sins are forgiven. Your place at the table is secure. Rise, and go with confidence, knowing that nothing can separate you from the friendship of Christ. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 103:1-14:

Bless the Lord, O my soul:

and all that is within me, bless his holy Name.

Bless the Lord, O my soul,

and forget not all his benefits:

Who forgiveth all thine iniquities;

who healeth all thy diseases;

Who redeemeth thy life from destruction;

who crowneth thee with loving kindness and tender mercies;

Who satisfieth thy mouth with good things;

so that thy youth is renewed like the eagle's.

The Lord executeth righteousness

and judgement for all that are oppressed.

He made known his ways unto Moses,

his acts unto the children of Israel.

The Lord is merciful and gracious,

slow to anger, and plenteous in mercy.

He will not always chide:

neither will he keep his anger for ever.

He hath not dealt with us after our sins;

nor rewarded us according to our iniquities.

For as the heaven is high above the earth,

so great is his mercy toward them that fear him.

As far as the east is from the west,

so far hath he removed our transgressions from us.

Like as a father pitieth his children,

so the Lord pitieth them that fear him.

For he knoweth our frame;

he remembered that we are dust.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the Friend who welcomes sinners;

Luke 15:1-7; Matthew 11:19

Then drew near unto him all the publicans and sinners for to hear him. And the Pharisees and scribes murmured, saying, This man receiveth sinners, and eateth with them. And he spake this parable unto them, saying, What man of you, having a hundred sheep, if he lose one of them, doth not leave the ninety and nine in the wilderness, and go after that which is lost, until he find it? And when he hath found it, he layeth it on his shoulders, rejoicing. And when he cometh home, he calleth together his friends and neighbours, saying unto them, Rejoice with me; for I have found my sheep which was lost. I say unto you, that likewise joy shall be in heaven over one sinner that repenteth, more than over ninety and nine just persons, which need no repentance… The Son of man came eating and drinking, and they say, Behold a man gluttonous, and a winebibber, a friend of publicans and sinners. But wisdom is justified of her children.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. ‘This man receiveth sinners, and eateth with them.’ What was meant as accusation is in fact the gospel. Jesus does not merely tolerate sinners from a distance; he receives them into intimacy, shares meals with them, makes them his companions. Table fellowship was the most intimate form of acceptance in his culture; and he offered it freely to the unworthy.
2. ‘He layeth it on his shoulders, rejoicing.’ The shepherd does not scold the sheep for wandering or demand that it walk home under its own power. He carries it. And more than that; he rejoices while carrying it. Your return to God is not a burden to him but a delight.
3. ‘A friend of publicans and sinners.’ Jesus did not merely serve sinners; he befriended them. There is a difference. Service can be condescending; friendship cannot. Jesus entered into genuine relationship with those the religious establishment rejected. He still does.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for hospitality and grace:

O God, who declarest thy almighty power chiefly in showing mercy and pity: Mercifully grant unto us such a measure of thy grace, that we, running the way of thy commandments, may obtain thy gracious promises, and be made partakers of thy heavenly treasure. And as thy Son welcomed sinners and ate with them, so grant that we may welcome all whom thou dost send to us, withholding from none the hospitality we have so freely received; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for outcasts, for those rejected by religious communities, and for a more welcoming Church.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: Do you truly believe that Christ is your friend? Not merely your saviour, your lord, your teacher; but your friend? How would your life change if you lived in the confidence of his friendship? And whom might you befriend in his name this day?

Lord Jesus Christ, Friend of sinners: I marvel that thou dost call me friend. I have done nothing to deserve such intimacy. I have much to make me unfit for thy company. Yet thou hast chosen me,

welcomed me, made a place for me at thy table. Help me to receive thy friendship without reserve or self-protection. And help me to extend to others the welcome I have received from thee. Show me today someone who needs a friend; someone overlooked, rejected, deemed unworthy of company. Let me be thy hands and heart to them; offering the same scandalous hospitality that thou hast offered me. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May Christ, the Friend of sinners, walk beside you this day. May he call you by name and welcome you to his table. May he give you grace to welcome others as he has welcomed you. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE TWENTIETH DAY

Life in the Spirit

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle, symbol of the Spirit's fire. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware of the One who dwells within you; closer than your breath, nearer than your thoughts, the very life of your life.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray the Veni Creator Spiritus, the ancient hymn to the Holy Spirit:

Come, Holy Ghost, our souls inspire,

and lighten with celestial fire.

Thou the anointing Spirit art,

who dost thy sevenfold gifts impart.

Thy blessed unction from above

is comfort, life, and fire of love.

Enable with perpetual light

the dullness of our blinded sight.

Anoint and cheer our soilèd face

with the abundance of thy grace.

Keep far our foes, give peace at home:

where thou art guide, no ill can come.

Teach us to know the Father, Son,

and thee, of both, to be but One,

that through the ages all along,

this may be our endless song:

Praise to thy eternal merit,

Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has grieved the indwelling Spirit:

O Holy Spirit, Lord and Giver of life: I confess that I have grieved thee by my sin. I have quenched thy fire with my coldness. I have resisted thy leading with my stubbornness. I have ignored thy whisper with my distraction. I have attributed to myself what was thy gift.

Thou hast made my body thy temple, and I have polluted it Thou hast offered me thy fruit, and I have preferred my own bitter harvest. Thou hast interceded for me with groanings too deep for words, and I have been deaf to thy prayers.

Forgive me, Holy Spirit. Revive thy flame within me. Bend my will to thine. Fill what is empty, warm what is cold, heal what is wounded. For without thee, I can do nothing. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The Spirit of the Lord rests upon you. He has not departed despite your failings. He has interceded for you even while you grieved him. Your sins are forgiven by the blood of Christ, applied to your heart by the Spirit who seals you for the day of redemption. Rise, and walk in the Spirit. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 104:24-31, 33-34:

O Lord, how manifold are thy works!

in wisdom hast thou made them all:

the earth is full of thy riches.

So is this great and wide sea,

wherein are things creeping innumerable,

both small and great beasts.

There go the ships:

there is that leviathan,

whom thou hast made to play therein.

These wait all upon thee;

that thou mayest give them their meat in due season.

That thou givest them they gather:

thou openest thine hand, they are filled with good.

Thou hidest thy face, they are troubled:

thou takest away their breath, they die,

and return to their dust.

Thou sendest forth thy spirit, they are created:

and thou renewest the face of the earth.

The glory of the Lord shall endure for ever:

the Lord shall rejoice in his works.

I will sing unto the Lord as long as I live:

I will sing praise to my God while I have my being.

My meditation of him shall be sweet:

I will be glad in the Lord.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of life in the Spirit:

Romans 8:9-11, 14-17, 26-27

But ye are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit, if so be that the Spirit of God dwell in you. Now if any man have not the Spirit of Christ, he is none of his. And if Christ be in you, the body is dead because of sin; but the Spirit is life because of righteousness. But if the Spirit of him that raised up Jesus from the dead dwell in you, he that raised up Christ from the dead shall also quicken your mortal bodies by his Spirit that dwelleth in you... For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God. For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear; but ye have received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father. The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit, that we are the children of God: And if children, then heirs; heirs of God, and joint-heirs with Christ... Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities: for we know not what we should pray for as we ought: but the Spirit itself maketh intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered. And he that searcheth the hearts knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit, because he maketh intercession for the saints according to the will of God.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit, that we are the children of God.' How do you know you belong to God? Not primarily by argument or evidence but by the inner testimony of the Spirit; that deep, wordless assurance that you are loved, that you are home, that you are his. Have you felt this witness?
2. 'Ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear.' The Spirit does not enslave but liberates. If your Christian life is marked primarily by fear; fear of judgement, fear of failure, fear of God's rejection; something has gone wrong. The Spirit cries 'Abba, Father,' not 'Master, spare me.'
3. 'The Spirit itself maketh intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered.' When you do not know how to

pray, when words fail you, when your needs are too deep for language; the Spirit prays in you and for you. Your inarticulate sighs are gathered up into divine intercession.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending especially to the words concerning the Holy Spirit:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for the gift of the Spirit:

O God, who on the day of Pentecost didst teach the hearts of thy faithful people by sending to them the light of the Holy Spirit:

Grant us by the same Spirit to have a right judgement in all things, and evermore to rejoice in his holy comfort; through the merits of Christ Jesus our Saviour, who liveth and reigneth with thee, in the unity of the same Spirit, one God, world without end. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for the renewal of the Church and the deepening of your own life in the Spirit.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What is the Spirit doing in your life right now? What fruit is he cultivating? What gifts is he giving? What promptings have you been ignoring?

Holy Spirit, Lord and Giver of life: I open myself to thee afresh this day. Come, not as a guest but as the Master of this house. Come, not to visit but to dwell. Come, not to advise but to rule.

Cultivate in me thy fruit; love, joy, peace patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control. Deploy in me thy gifts for the building up of the Body. Lead me in the way I should go. Speak to me the words I need to hear. Pray in me the prayers I cannot form. Fill me, flood me, overflow me; that others may encounter not me but thee. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May the Holy Spirit, who brooded over the waters at creation, brood over your life this day. May he who filled the apostles with power fill you with courage. May he who intercedes for you with sighs too deep for words carry your prayers to the throne of grace. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE TWENTY-FIRST DAY

The Communion of Saints

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware that you do not pray alone. Around you, unseen but real, stand the saints of all ages; patriarchs and prophets, apostles and martyrs, confessors and virgins, and all the faithful departed who have gone before you marked with the sign of faith.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from the All Saints' Day liturgy:

Almighty God, who hast knit together thine elect in one communion and fellowship in the mystical body of thy Son Christ our Lord: Grant us grace so to follow thy blessed saints in all virtuous and godly living, that we may come to those ineffable joys which thou hast prepared for them that unfeignedly love thee; through Jesus Christ our Lord, who with thee and the Holy Spirit liveth and reigneth, one God, in glory everlasting. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who stands within the great company of the redeemed:

Almighty and most merciful Father, I confess that I have lived as though the faith were my private possession, as though I were the first to walk this way, as though I must figure everything out alone. I have neglected the wisdom of those who have gone before me. I have ignored the example of the saints. I have acted as though the Church began with my generation and will end with it.

I confess too that I have failed my brothers and sisters who walk beside me. I have withheld the encouragement they needed. I have refused the correction they offered. I have preferred isolation to communion, independence to interdependence.

Forgive my arrogant solitude. Knit me into the communion of saints; past, present, and future. Let me receive from those who have gone before and give to those who come after, that together we may glorify thee. Through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

You are surrounded by a great cloud of witnesses. You are not alone. The prayers of the saints rise with your prayers. The communion that unites you to Christ unites you to all who are his. Your sins are forgiven; you are restored to fellowship. Go in peace, and live as a member of that blessed company. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray the Te Deum laudamus, the ancient hymn of the Church triumphant and militant:

We praise thee, O God; we acknowledge thee to be the Lord.

All the earth doth worship thee, the Father everlasting.

To thee all Angels cry aloud, the Heavens and all the Powers therein.

To thee Cherubim and Seraphim continually do cry:

Holy, Holy, Holy, Lord God of Sabaoth;

Heaven and earth are full of the Majesty of thy glory.

The glorious company of the Apostles praise thee.

The goodly fellowship of the Prophets praise thee.

The noble army of Martyrs praise thee.

The holy Church throughout all the world doth acknowledge thee,

the Father of an infinite Majesty,

thine honourable, true, and only Son,

also the Holy Ghost the Comforter.

Thou art the King of Glory, O Christ.

Thou art the everlasting Son of the Father.

When thou tookest upon thee to deliver man,

thou didst not abhor the Virgin's womb.

When thou hadst overcome the sharpness of death,

thou didst open the Kingdom of Heaven to all believers.

Thou sittest at the right hand of God, in the glory of the Father.

We believe that thou shalt come to be our Judge.

We therefore pray thee, help thy servants,

whom thou hast redeemed with thy precious blood.

Make them to be numbered with thy Saints in glory everlasting.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the great cloud of witnesses:

Hebrews 11:32-40; 12:1-2

And what shall I more say? for the time would fail me to tell of Gedeon, and of Barak, and of Samson, and of Jephthae; of David also, and Samuel, and of the prophets: Who through faith subdued kingdoms, wrought righteousness, obtained promises, stopped the mouths of lions, quenched the violence of fire, escaped the edge of the sword, out of the weakness were made strong, waxed valiant in fight, turned to flight the armies of the aliens. Women received their dead raised to life again: and others were tortured, not accepting deliverance; that they might obtain a better resurrection... And these all, having obtained a good report through faith, received not the promise: God having provided some better thing for us, that they without us should not be made perfect. Wherefore seeing we also are compassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which doth so easily beset us, and let us run with patience the race that is set before us, looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. ‘They without us should not be made perfect.’ The saints who have gone before are not complete without you. The communion of saints is not a finished tapestry but an ongoing work into which your thread is being woven. You are necessary to the wholeness of God’s people.
2. ‘Compassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses.’ The stadium is full. The race you run is watched by those who have run before you. They are not passive spectators but active participants; cheering, encouraging, testifying by their lives that the race can be finished, the crown obtained.
3. ‘Looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith.’ The saints do not draw our gaze to themselves but to Christ. They are witnesses precisely because they point beyond themselves to the one who perfected their faith and will perfect yours. Every saint is a finger pointing to Jesus.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending especially to the words ‘the communion of saints’:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for the faithful departed:

O Almighty God, who hast knit together thine elect in one communion and fellowship: We give thee thanks for all thy servants who have departed this life in thy faith and fear, and we humbly beseech thee that we, with all who have fallen asleep in Christ, may have our perfect consummation and bliss, both in body and soul, in thine eternal and everlasting glory; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Add your own intercessions. You may wish to name particular saints whose lives have inspired you, as well as faithful departed whom you have known personally.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: Whose faith has shaped your faith? Who are the saints; famous or obscure, living or dead, who have shown you what it means to follow Christ? How might you become such a witness for others?

Almighty God, I thank thee for the saints who have gone before me. I thank thee for their example, their prayers, their perseverance. I thank thee that I do not walk alone but in company with all who have loved thee.

This day, make me a faithful member of this communion. Let me receive the wisdom of those who have gone before. Let me encourage those who walk beside me. Let me leave a legacy for those who come after. And at the last, bring me with all thy saints to the joy of thy heavenly kingdom, where we shall see thee face to face and praise thee forever. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May God, who has given you the fellowship of the saints, grant you grace to follow their example and share their glory. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE TWENTY-SECOND DAY

The Christian Vocation

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, considering that this day, with all its ordinary tasks, its mundane responsibilities, its seemingly secular demands, is the arena of your calling. God placed you precisely where you are for purposes that are holy, though they may not appear so.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from George Herbert:

Teach me, my God and King, in all things thee to see, and what I do in any thing, to do it as for thee. A man that looks on glass, on it may stay his eye; or if he pleaseth, through it pass, and then the heaven espy. All may of thee partake: nothing can be so mean, which with this tincture, 'for thy sake,' will not grow bright and clean. A servant with this clause makes drudgery divine: who sweeps a room, as for thy laws, makes that and the action fine. This is the famous stone that turneth all to gold; for that which God doth touch and own cannot for less be told. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has failed to see work as worship:

Almighty God, who hast called us to glorify thee in all that we do: I confess that I have divided my life into sacred and secular, as though some hours belonged to thee and others did not. I have treated my work as mere necessity, my daily tasks as interruptions to my 'real' spiritual life, my ordinary responsibilities as beneath thy notice.

I confess that I have sought escape from my calling rather than faithfulness within it. I have envied others' vocations. I have despised the smallness of my sphere. I have forgotten that thou hast placed me here, and that here is holy ground.

Forgive my sacred-secular divide. Forgive my vocational discontent. Open my eyes to see that every task done in love is service to thee, and that the humblest work, offered to thy glory, shines with eternal significance. Through Jesus Christ, who worked with his hands in Nazareth. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

God has called you; not to some other life but to this one; not to some other place but to where you are. Your sins of discontent and division are forgiven. Go now to your work, knowing that the Lord of all creation delights in your labour done for love of him. Whatever you do, in word or deed, do all in the name of the Lord Jesus. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 90:12-17, praying for God's blessing on daily work:

So teach us to number our days,

that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom.

Return, O Lord, how long?

and let it repent thee concerning thy servants.

O satisfy us early with thy mercy;

that we may rejoice and be glad all our days.

Make us glad according to the days wherein thou hast afflicted us,

and the years wherein we have seen evil.

Let thy work appear unto thy servants,

and thy glory unto their children.

And let the beauty of the Lord our God be upon us;

and establish thou the work of our hands upon us;

yea, the work of our hands establish thou it.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of faithful labour:

Colossians 3:17, 23-24; 1 Corinthians 10:31

And whatsoever ye do in word or deed, do all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God and the Father by him... And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily as to the Lord, and not unto men;

Knowing that of the Lord ye shall receive the reward of the inheritance: for ye serve the Lord Christ… Whether therefore ye eat, or drink, or whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'Whatsoever ye do.' Not 'whatever religious things you do' or 'whatever impressive things you do,' but whatsoever. The scope is total. There is no action too small, no task too mundane, no work too secular to be done 'in the name of the Lord Jesus.' Your vocation encompasses every moment.
2. 'As to the Lord, and not unto men.' The quality of your work is not determined by who is watching. The sluggard works hard when the boss is present; the Christian works hard because the Lord is always present. Your true employer is Christ, and his standards are both higher and more gracious than any human supervisor's.
3. 'For ye serve the Lord Christ.' The executive and the janitor, the mother and the monk, the artist and the accountant; all serve the same Lord if they offer their work to him. There is no hierarchy of holiness based on profession. The question is not what you do but whether you do it for Christ.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for faithfulness in vocation:

Almighty God our heavenly Father, who declarest thy glory and showest forth thy handiwork in the heavens and in the earth: Deliver us, we beseech thee, in our several callings, from the service of self alone, that we may do the work which thou givest us to do, in truth and beauty and for the common good; for the sake of him who came among us as one that serveth, thy Son Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those who are seeking their vocation and in difficult circumstances.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What is your vocation; not merely your job but the whole complex of responsibilities and relationships to which God has called you? How might you sanctify your ordinary work this day?

Lord Jesus Christ, who for thirty years laboured with thy hands in Nazareth before thy public ministry began: Sanctify my work this day. Whether I work with hands or mind, with words or numbers, with people or things; let all my labour be an offering to thee.

When the work is tedious, give me patience. When the work is difficult, give me perseverance. When the work seems meaningless, remind me that nothing done for thee is wasted. When I am tempted to cut corners, help me remember that thou art my true employer.

At the end of this day, whether I have succeeded or failed by the world's measure, let me hear thee say, 'Well done, good and faithful servant.' For I desire no other reward than thy 'Well done.' Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Go forth to your work and to your labour. May the beauty of the Lord our God be upon you. May he establish the work of your hands. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and

the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you this day and forever. Amen.

THE TWENTY-THIRD DAY

The Pilgrimage of Faith

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, recognising that you are not yet home. This life is a journey, a pilgrimage toward a city whose builder and maker is God. You are a stranger and exile on earth, pressing on toward the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from Augustine's Confessions:

O God, thou hast made us for thyself, and our hearts are restless until they rest in thee. We are pilgrims in this world, strangers passing through, seeking a better country; that is, a heavenly one. Lead us, we beseech thee, by paths that we know not, through dangers seen and unseen, until we reach the city which hath foundations, whose builder and maker thou art. And grant that in our journeying we may not grow weary, nor turn aside to lesser destinations, but press on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus our Lord. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as a pilgrim who has wandered from the path:

O God, who hast set eternity in our hearts and called us to a homeland we have never seen: I confess that I have lost my way. I have mistaken wayside inns for my final destination. I have grown comfortable in exile. I have forgotten that I am a pilgrim passing through.

I confess that I have grown weary on the journey. I have looked back with longing at what I left behind. I have complained about the difficulty of the road. I have envied those who seem to travel lighter than I.

Forgive my forgetfulness, my weariness, my discontent. Set my face again toward the heavenly city. Give me pilgrim grace; travelling light helping fellow travellers, keeping my eyes on the horizon where home awaits. Through Jesus Christ, who himself had nowhere to lay his head. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The Lord your God goes before you and behind you. He is your guide and your rearguard. Your wanderings are forgiven; your way is made straight. Rise, pilgrim, and continue your journey. The celestial city draws nearer with every step. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 84, the psalm of the pilgrim longing for God's house:

How amiable are thy tabernacles, O Lord of hosts!

My soul longeth, yea, even fainteth for the courts of the Lord:

my heart and my flesh crieth out for the living God.

Yea, the sparrow hath found an house, and the swallow a nest for herself,

where she may lay her young, even thine altars, O Lord of hosts, my Kind, and my God.

Blessed are they that dwell in thy house: they will be still praising thee.

Blessed is the man whose strength is in thee; in whose heart are the ways of them.

Who passing through the valley of Baca make it a well;

the rain also filleth the pools.

They go from strength to strength, every one of them in Zion appeareth before God.

O Lord God of hosts, hear my prayer: give ear, O God of Jacob.

Behold, O God our shield, and look upon the face of thine anointed.

For a day in thy courts is better than a thousand.

I had rather be a doorkeeper in the house of my God,

than to dwell in the tents of wickedness.

For the Lord God is a sun and shield: the Lord will give grace and glory:

no good thing will he withhold from them that walk uprightly.

O Lord of hosts, blessed is the man that trusteth in thee.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the pilgrim people:

Hebrews 11:8-10, 13-16

By faith Abraham, when he was called to go out into a place which he should after receive for an inheritance, obeyed; and he went out, not knowing whither he went. By faith he sojourned in the land of promise, as in a strange country, dwelling in tabernacles with Isaac and Jacob, the heirs with him of the same promise: For he looked for a city which hath foundations, whose builder and maker is God... These all died in faith, not having received the promises, but having seen them afar off, and were persuaded of them, and embraced them, and confessed that they were strangers and pilgrims on the earth. For they that say such things declare plainly that they seek a country. And truly, if they had been mindful of that country from whence they came out, they might have had opportunity to have returned. But now they desire a better country, that is, an heavenly: wherefore God is not ashamed to be called their God: for he hath prepared for them a city.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'He went out, not knowing whither he went.' Faith is not a detailed roadmap but trust in the Guide. Abraham did not know the destination when he started; he only knew the One who called. Can you take the next step without knowing where the journey will end?

2. ‘They confessed that they were strangers and pilgrims on the earth.’ This confession is not pessimism but freedom. Those who know they are pilgrims travel light. They do not cling to what they cannot keep. They invest in what cannot be taken away.
3. ‘God is not ashamed to be called their God.’ The pilgrim’s journey is not solitary; it is a journey with God. He has identified himself with wanderers and exiles, strangers and sojourners. Your homelessness here is the condition for being at home with him.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayer:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive

those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for pilgrims:

O God, who hast prepared for them that love thee such good things as pass man's understanding: Pour into our hearts such love toward thee, that we, loving thee above all things, may obtain thy promises, which exceed all that we can desire. Keep us, we beseech thee, in our earthly pilgrimage, and bring us at length to that heavenly country where thou hast prepared a place for us; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those who journey; refugees, migrants, and all who have left home.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What have you mistaken for your final destination? What weights do you need to lay aside to travel more freely? What fellow pilgrims need your companionship on the journey?

Lord Jesus Christ, who on earth hadst not where to lay thy head: I confess that I have often confused wayside inns with home. I have accumulated what I cannot carry. I have put down roots where I am only meant to pass through.

Give me pilgrim eyes to see this world rightly; beautiful but passing, good but not ultimate, gift to receive but not a treasure to hoard. Give me pilgrim feet to keep walking when I grow weary, to help others on the path, to keep moving toward the city whose builder and maker is God.

And give me pilgrim hope; the certainty that home awaits that the journey has an end, that the Father watches for my coming. Until I arrive, keep me faithful on the way. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

The Lord preserve your going out and your coming in, from this time forth and even for evermore. May he guide your feet on the pilgrim way and bring you at last to the heavenly city. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE TWENTY-FOURTH DAY

The School of Prayer

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, recognising the profound privilege of prayer; that the Creator of the universe invites conversation, that the King of kings welcomes petition, that the Almighty God desires communion with creatures of dust.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from Origen:

O God, who dost invite us to ask that we might receive, to seek that we might find, to knock that it might be opened unto us: Teach us to pray. We know not how to pray as we ought, but thy Spirit helpeth our infirmities and maketh intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered. Lift us beyond our stammering words into communion with thee. Open our lips that our mouths may show forth thy praise. Incline our hearts that we may desire what thou desirest. And grant that in prayer we may not merely speak to thee but hear from thee, that we may know thee and be changed by thee. Through Jesus Christ our Lord, who ever liveth to make intercession for us. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has failed in the school of prayer:

O Lord, who hast commanded us to pray always and not to faint: I confess that I have been a poor student in the school of prayer. My prayers have been infrequent, distracted, and half-hearted. I have come to thee with lists of requests but little genuine desire for thy presence. I have spoken many words but listened seldom.

I confess that I have used prayer to bend thy will rather than to discover it. I have prayed as though informing thee of needs thou didst not know. I have treated thee as a divine vending machine rather than as my Father and my God.

Forgive my prayerlessness, my distraction, my manipulation. Teach me to pray as thy Son taught his disciples. Let me come not as one making demands but as one seeking the Father's face. Through the same Jesus Christ, who taught us to pray. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The Father sees in secret and rewards openly. He knows your needs before you ask. He hears your sighs and counts your tears. Your failures in prayer are forgiven; your half-formed words are understood. The Spirit intercedes where your prayers fall short. Rise, and learn again to pray. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 63:1-8;

O God, thou art my God; early will I seek thee:

my soul thirsteth for thee, my flesh longeth for thee

in a dry and thirsty land, where no water is;

To see thy power and thy glory, so as I have seen thee in the sanctuary.

Because thy loving kindness is better than life, my lips shall praise thee.

Thus will I bless thee while I live: I will lift up my hands in thy Name.

My soul shall be satisfied as with marrow and fatness;

and my mouth shall praise thee with joyful lips:

When I remember thee upon my bed, and meditate on thee in the night watches.

Because thou hast been my help, therefore in the shadow of thy wings will I rejoice.

My soul followeth hard after thee: thy right hand upholdeth me.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word concerning prayer:

Luke 11:1-4, 9-13

And it came to pass, that, as he was praying in a certain place, when he ceased, one of his disciples said unto him, Lord, teach us to pray, as John also taught his disciples. And he said unto them, When ye pray, say, Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth. Give us day by day our daily bread. And forgive us our sins; for we also forgive every one that is indebted to us. And lead us not into temptation; but deliver us from evil… And I say unto you, Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you. For every one that asketh receiveth; and that seeketh findeth; and to him that knocketh it shall be opened. If a son shall ask bread of any of you that is a father, will he give him a stone? or if he ask a fish, will he for a fish give him a serpent? Or if he shall ask an egg, will he offer him a scorpion? If ye then, being evil, know how to give good gifts unto your children: how much more shall your heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to the, that ask him?

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'Lord, teach us to pray.' Prayer must be learned. It does not come naturally to fallen creatures who prefer monologue to dialogue, demand to request, independence to dependence. But Jesus is willing to teach, and the lesson begins with two words: 'Our Father.'
2. 'If a son shall ask bread… will he give him a stone?' Jesus invites us to reason from the lesser to the greater. If sinful parents give good gifts to their children, how much more will the Father? Prayer is not coaxing a reluctant deity but asking a generous Father.
3. 'How much more shall your heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit.' The greatest gift is not any particular blessing but the Giver himself. When we ask and receive the Spirit, we

receive the one who prays within us, who knows the Father's will, who transforms our asking.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit. Pray the Lord's Prayer slowly, as though learning it for the first time, pausing to consider each petition:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, praying slowly and attentively.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What hinders your prayer life? What would it look like to grow in the discipline and delight of prayer?

Lord Jesus Christ, who withdrew to lonely places to pray, who spent whole nights in communion with the Father, who taught thy disciples and still teaches me: I want to learn to pray.

Deliver me from the distraction that keeps me from thy presence. Deliver me from the laziness that prefers sleep to prayer. Deliver me from the self-sufficiency that thinks I can manage without thee.

Teach me the prayer of adoration that gazes upon thy beauty. Teach me the prayer of confession that names my sin honestly. Teach me the prayer of thanksgiving that acknowledges thy gifts. Teach me the prayer of supplication that brings my needs to thee.

And beyond all words, teach me the prayer of silence; the prayer that rests in thy presence, that waits for thy voice, that communes with thee as friend with friend. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May the God who hears prayer draw you into ever deeper communion with himself. May the Son who ever lives to intercede

join his prayers to yours. May the Spirit who helps your infirmities teach you to pray as you ought. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE TWENTY-FIFTH DAY

The Dying Life

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, pondering the paradox at the heart of Christian existence: that we must die to live, that we must lose to find, that we must let go to receive. The way down is the way up.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from Thomas à Kempis:

O Lord Jesus Christ, who hast said that unless a grain of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone, but if it die, it bringeth forth much fruit: Teach me the secret of the dying life. For I would live, and lo, I die daily. I would grasp, and thou teachest me to release. I would rise, and thou showest me the way down. Grant me grace to embrace thy cross, to take up my own cross daily, and to follow thee through death to life, through darkness to light, through the grave to glory. For thy sake, who for my sake didst die and rise again. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has resisted the dying life:

O Lord, who hast called me to take up my cross and follow thee: I confess that I have refused the way of the cross. I have sought life while avoiding death. I have wanted the fruit without the falling into the ground. I have desired resurrection glory while rejecting crucifixion shame.

I confess my clinging to what thou wouldst have me release; my reputation, my comfort, my control, my very self. I confess my fear of the deaths that precede new life; the death of cherished plans, the death of beloved illusions, the death of the self I have so carefully constructed.

Forgive my refusal of the cross. Give me courage to die daily, trusting that on the other side of every death thou dost prepare a resurrection. Through Jesus Christ who for the joy set before him endured the cross, despising the shame. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

The Lord who died that you might live now speaks life to you. Your fear of death is forgiven. Your clinging is released. Rise; not to avoid the cross but to embrace it, knowing that the path through death leads to indestructible life. Your sins are forgiven; go in peace. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 116:1-9, 12-14:

I love the Lord, because he hath heard my voice and my supplications.

Because he hath inclined his ear unto me, therefore will I call upon him as long as I live.

The sorrows of death compassed me, and the pains of hell gat hold upon me:

I found trouble and sorrow. Then called I upon the Name of the Lord;

O Lord, I beseech thee, deliver my soul.

Gracious is the Lord, and righteous; year, our God is merciful.

The Lord preserveth the simple; I was brought low, and he helped me.

Return unto thy rest, O my soul; for the Lord hath dealt bountifully with thee.

For thou hast delivered my soul from death, mine eyes from tears, and my feet from falling.

I will walk before the Lord in the land of the living.

What shall I render unto the Lord for all his benefits toward me?

I will take the cup of salvation, and call upon the Name of the Lord.

I will pay my vows unto the Lord now in the presence of all his people.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the dying life:

John 12:24-26; 2 Corinthians 4:7-12

Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except a corn of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone: but if it die, it bringeth forth much fruit. He that loveth his life shall lose it; and he that hateth his life in this world shall keep it unto life eternal. If any man serve me, let him follow me; and where I am, there shall also my servant be: if any man serve me, him will my Father honour... But we have this treasure in earthen vessels, that the excellency of the power may be of God, and not of us. We are troubled on every side, yet not distressed; we are perplexed, but not in despair; Persecuted but not forsaken; cast down, but not destroyed; Always bearing about in the body the dying of the Lord Jesus, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our body. For we which live are alway delivered unto death for Jesus' sake, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our mortal flesh. So then death worketh in us, but life in you.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'Except a corn of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone.' The grain that refuses to be buried remains a single grain. Fruitfulness requires death. What might God bring forth from you if you were willing to be buried?
2. 'Always bearing about in the body the dying of the Lord Jesus, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest.' The Christian carries death and life simultaneously, dying to self that Christ might live through us, decreasing that he might increase. This is not occasional but constant: 'always bearing about.'

3. ‘Death worketh in us, but life in you.’ Our dying bears fruit in others’ living. The sacrifice of parents gives life to children. The death of martyrs gives life to the Church. The sufferings of the faithful become the seed of new believers. Your deaths are not wasted; they are generative.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayers:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for dying and rising with Christ:

Almighty God, whose Son Jesus Christ for our sake was content to bear the shame of the cross: Grant that we may glory in no other thing save in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, through which the world is crucified unto us, and we unto the world; that, dying with him, we might rise with him to newness of life, and at the last day be raised up to dwell with him in glory; who liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, world without end. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those facing physical death and those called to costly discipleship.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What is God asking you to release? What death precedes the life he wishes to bring forth in you? What cross is yours to carry this day?

Lord Jesus Christ, who for the joy that was set before thee didst endure the cross, despising the shame: I acknowledge that I fear the deaths that precede life. I fear the loss of my reputation, my security, my plans, my very self.

Yet I see in thee that the way down is the way up, that the path through death leads to indestructible life. Give me courage to fall into the ground. Give me faith to trust that what dies in thy hands rises again transformed.

This day, I offer thee my deaths, the small dyings of every hour, the letting go of preferences and comforts, the release of control. And I trust thee for the life that comes only through dying: fruit that remains, love that persists, joy that cannot be taken away. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May Christ, who died and rose again, teach you the secret of the dying life. May he give you grace to fall into the ground, trusting in the harvest he will bring. May you bear about in your body the dying of Jesus, that the life of Jesus might be manifest in you. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE TWENTY-SIXTH DAY

The Sacramental Life

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware that the material world is not a barrier to the spiritual but a vehicle for it. In water, bread, wine, oil, and the laying on of hands, God meets us through created things; for he who made matter can surely use matter to convey grace.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation from the Prayer of Humble Access:

We do not presume to come to this thy Table, O merciful Lord, trusting in our own righteousness, but in thy manifold and great mercies. We are not worthy so much as to gather up the crumbs under thy Table. But thou art the same Lord, whose property is always to have mercy: Grant us therefore, gracious Lord, so to eat the flesh of thy dear Son Jesus Christ, and to drink his blood, that our sinful bodies may be made clean by his body, and our souls washed through his most precious blood, and that we may evermore dwell in him, and he in us. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has neglected or misunderstood the sacraments:

Almighty God, who hast ordained outward and visible signs to convey inward and spiritual grace: I confess that I have often despised the material means thou hast appointed. I have treated the sacraments as mere rituals, empty forms, optional extras to the 'real' spiritual life.

I confess too that I have sometimes made the opposite error; trusting in the outward sign while neglecting the inward disposition, receiving the elements without faith, going through the motions without engaging the heart.

Forgive my contempt for thy appointed means. Forgive my superstitious reliance on empty forms. Teach me to receive thy sacraments with faith, to encounter thee truly in water, bread, and wine, and to live a sacramental life in which all creation speaks of thy glory. Through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

God, who in baptism claimed you as his own and in the Eucharist feeds you with the body and blood of his Son, forgives all your sins and restores you to communion with himself. The grace of the sacraments is yours; not by your deserving but by his giving. Go in peace. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 42:1-5, the psalm of longing for God's presence:

As the hart panteth after the water brooks.

so panteth my soul after thee, O God.

My soul thirsteth for God, for the living God:

when shall I come and appear before God?

My tears have been meat day and night,

while they continually say unto me, Where is thy God?

When I remember these things, I pour out my soul in me:

for I had gone with the multitude,

I went with them to the house of God,

with the voice of joy and praise,

with a multitude that kept holyday.

Why art thou cast down, O my soul?

and why art thou disquieted in me?

hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him

for the help of his countenance.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of sacramental grace:

John 6:53-58; 1 Corinthians 10:16-17

Then Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man, and drink his blood, ye have no life in you. Whoso eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, hath eternal life; and I will raise him up at the last day. For my flesh is meat indeed, and my blood is drink indeed. He that eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, dwelleth in me, and I in him. As the living Father hath sent me, and I live by the Father: so he that eateth me, even he shall live by me. This is that bread which came down from heaven: not as your fathers did eat manna, and are dead: he that eateth of this bread shall live for ever... The cup of blessing which we bless, is it not the communion of the blood of Christ? The bread which we break, is it not the communion of the body of Christ? For we being many are one bread, and one body: for we are all partakers of that one bread.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider

1. 'Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man, and drink his blood, ye have no life in you.' These are hard words. Jesus does not soften them when his disciples murmur. He intends something profound; not mere metaphor but real participation in his life through the appointed means.
2. 'He that eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, dwelleth in me, and I in him.' The sacrament effects what it signifies: union with Christ. In receiving the bread and wine, we do not merely remember an absent Lord; we commune with a present Saviour who gives himself to us.
3. 'We being many are one bread, and one body.' The sacrament is not private devotion but corporate participation. At the Table we are united not only to Christ but to one another. The same body that feeds us binds us together as members of that body.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed.

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayers:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this post-communion collect:

Almighty and everliving God, we most heartily thank thee, for that thou dost vouchsafe to feed us who have duly received these holy mysteries, with the spiritual food of the most precious Body and Blood of thy Son our Saviour Jesus Christ; and dost assure us thereby of thy favour and goodness towards us; and that we are very members incorporate in the mystical body of thy Son, which is the blessed company of all faithful people; and are also heirs through hope of thy everlasting kingdom. And we humbly beseech thee, O

heavenly Father, so to assist us with thy grace, that we may continue in that holy fellowship, and do all such good works as thou hast prepared for us to walk in. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for the Church's faithful celebration of the sacraments.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: How do you approach the sacraments? With what disposition do you come to the Table? How might you live more sacramentally, seeing all of life as a potential vehicle for divine grace?

Lord Jesus Christ, who hast given us thy body and blood in the sacrament of the altar: Grant that I may never come of thy Table carelessly, never receive thee without faith, never depart unchanged by thy grace.

And beyond the formal sacraments, teach me to live sacramentally, to see thy presence in the ordinary things of life, to receive every gift as from thy hand, to find in water and bread and wine the traces of thy creative and redeeming love.

Let all creation become for me a window to thy glory, a door to thy presence, a means of thy grace. For thou art everywhere present, filling all things, and I would learn to find thee in all things and all things in thee. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.

℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

May Christ, who feeds you with his body and blood, nourish you for eternal life. May he who meets you in water, bread, and wine meet you in all the circumstances of this day. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE TWENTY-SEVENTH DAY

The Body of Christ

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, becoming aware that you are not a solitary Christian but a member of a body; connected to believers across the street and across the world, bound together with those who have gone before and those who will come after, part of something far larger than yourself.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from Augustine:

O God, who hast made us members one of another in the body of thy Son: Grant that we may discern the body, honouring Christ in each member, receiving from one another and giving to one another as thy Spirit directs. Heal the divisions that wound thy Church. Humble the pride that separates us from our brothers and sisters. And grant that, being many, we may be one, one bread, one body, that the world may believe that thou hast sent thy Son. Through the same Jesus Christ our Lord, who is the Head of the body, the Church. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has wounded the body:

Almighty God, who hast called us into one body in Christ: I confess that I have sinned against the body. I have elevated my own gifts and despised others'. I have withdrawn when I should have contributed. I have demanded when I should have served. I have divided what thou wouldst have united.

I confess that I have harboured bitterness against fellow members, nursed grievances rather than seeking reconciliation, and valued my comfort over the body's health. I have been an eye that said to the hand, 'I have no need of thee.'

Forgive my sins against the body of Christ. Heal the wounds I have inflicted. Restore me to right relationship with my brothers and sisters. And teach me to discern the body; to see Christ in each member and to serve him by serving them. Through Jesus Christ, the Head of the body. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

God, who has reconciled you to himself through Christ, now reconciles you to your brothers and sisters in Christ. Your sins against the body are forgiven. Go, and be a minister of reconciliation; healing where you have wounded, building up where you have torn down, uniting where you have divided. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 133, the psalm of unity:

Behold, how good and how pleasant it is

for brethren to dwell together in unity!

It is like the precious ointment upon the head,

that ran down upon the beard, even Aaron's beard:

that went down to the skirts of his garments;

As the dew of Hermon,

and as the dew that descended upon the mountains of Zion:

for there the Lord commanded the blessing,

even life for evermore.

Continue with Psalm 122:1-9:

I was glad when they said unto me,

Let us go into the house of the Lord.

Our feet shall stand within thy gates, O Jerusalem.

Jerusalem is builded as a city that is compact together:

Whither the tribes go up, the tribes of the Lord,

unto the testimony of Israel, to give thanks unto the Name of the Lord.

For there are set thrones of judgement, the thrones of the house of David.

Pray for the peace of Jerusalem: they shall prosper that love thee.

Peace be within thy walls, and prosperity within thy palaces.

For my brethren and companions' sakes, I will now say, Peace be within thee.

Because of the house of the Lord our God I will seek thy good.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the body:

1 Corinthians 12:12-14, 20-27

For as the body is one, and hath many members, and all the members of that one body, being many, are one body: so also is Christ. For by one Spirit are we all baptised into one body, whether we be Jews or Gentiles, whether we be bond or free; and have been all made to drink into one Spirit. For the body is not one member, but many... But now are they many members, yet but one body. And the eye cannot say unto the hand, I have no need of thee: nor again the head to the feet, I have no need of you. Nay, much more those members of the body, which seem to be more feeble, are necessary: And those members of the body, which we think to be less honourable, upon those we bestow more abundant honour... That there should be no schism in the body; but that the members should have the same care one for another. And whether one member suffer, all the members suffer with it; or one member be honoured, all the members rejoice with it. Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider:

1. ‘The body is not one member, but many.’ Diversity is not a problem to be solved but a gift to be celebrated. The body needs its variety of parts to function. Your differences from other Christians are not obstacles to unity but contributions to wholeness.
2. ‘Those members of the body, which seem to be more feeble, are necessary.’ The world honours the prominent, the powerful, the impressive. The body of Christ honours the weak, the hidden, the seemingly insignificant. The parts you might overlook are indispensable.
3. ‘Whether one member suffer, all the members suffer with it.’ You cannot isolate yourself from the body’s pain or joy. The refugee church in Syria, the persecuted believers in North Korea, the struggling congregation across town; their suffering is yours, and your flourishing is theirs.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending especially to the words ‘the holy catholic Church’:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayers:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for the unity of the Church:

O God the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, our only Saviour, the Prince of Peace: Give us grace seriously to lay to heart the great dangers we are in by our unhappy divisions. Take away all hatred and prejudice, and whatsoever else may hinder us from godly union and concord; that as there is but one Body and one Spirit, and one hope of our calling, one Lord, one Faith, one Baptism, one God and Father of us all, so we may be all one heart and of one soul, united in one holy bond of truth and peace, of faith and charity, and may with one mind and one mouth glorify thee; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for the unity of the Church and for Christians who suffer.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: How are you contributing to the body of Christ? What gifts has God given you for the building up of the body? Where have you contributed to division, and where might you become an instrument of unity?

Lord Jesus Christ, Head of the body: I acknowledge that I am not my own. I belong to thee, and I belong to thy body. My gifts are not for my glory but for the common good. My weaknesses are opportunities for others to serve me and for thy power to be made perfect.

Forgive me for the ways I have wounded the body; by criticism, by withdrawal, by pride, by refusal to forgive. Heal the divisions I have caused. And show me my place in the body; what part I am to play, what gifts I am to contribute, what members I am to serve.

And grant, O Lord, that thy Church throughout the world may be united in truth and love, that the scandal of our divisions may be healed, and that all who confess thy Name may be one, even as thou and the Father are one. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

May Christ, the Head of the body, coordinate your gifts for the building up of his Church. May the Spirit, who baptised you into one body, bind you in love to your brothers and sisters. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE TWENTY-EIGHTH DAY

The Works of Mercy

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, considering that what you do to the least of Christ's brothers and sisters, you do to him. In the hungry, the thirsty, the stranger, the naked, the sick, and the imprisoned, Christ himself awaits your service.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from the works of mercy tradition:

O God, who art thyself the Father of mercies and the God of all comfort: Grant us grace to show forth thy mercy in our lives. Thou hast fed us; teach us to feed the hungry. Thou hast given us drink from the living water; teach us to give drink to the thirsty. Thou hast welcomed us as strangers into thy household; teach us to welcome the stranger. Thou hast clothed us with the garments of salvation; teach us to clothe the naked. Thou hast visited us in our affliction; teach us to visit the sick. Thou hast freed us from the prison of sin; teach us to visit the imprisoned. For in serving them we serve thee, and in loving them we love thee. Through Jesus Christ, who came not to be served but to serve. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has failed to show mercy:

Almighty God, whose Son Jesus Christ identified himself with the poor and the suffering: I confess that I have passed by on the other side. I have seen the hungry and not fed them, the thirsty and not given them drink, the stranger and not welcomed them, the naked and not clothed them, the sick and not visited them, the imprisoned and not come to them.

I confess that I have made excuses for my failure; too busy, too poor myself, too uncertain how to help, too afraid. I have loved in word and in tongue but not in deed and in truth. I have received thy mercy but not extended it to others.

Forgive my merciless life. Open my eyes to see Christ in the suffering. Open my hands to serve him in his members. And grant that at the last I may hear thee say, 'Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me.' Amen.

Receive the absolution:

God, who is rich in mercy, forgives your failures to show mercy. The compassion you have not shown, he has shown to you. Rise, forgiven and freed, and go to show others the mercy you have received. For blessed are the merciful, for they shall obtain mercy. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 146:

Praise ye the Lord. Praise the Lord, O my soul.

While I live will I praise the Lord:

I will sing praises unto my God while I have any being.

Put not your trust in princes, nor in the son of man, in whom there is no help.

His breath goeth forth, he returneth to his earth;

in that very day his thoughts perish.

Happy is he that hath the God of Jacob for his help,

whose hope is in the Lord his God:

Which made heaven, and earth, the sea, and all that therein is:

which keepeth truth for ever:

Which executeth judgment for the oppressed:

which giveth food to the hungry.

The Lord looseth the prisoners:

The Lord openeth the eyes of the blind:

the Lord raiseth them that are bowed down:

the Lord loveth the righteous:

The Lord preserveth the strangers;

he relieveth the fatherless and widow:

but the way of the wicked he turneth upside down.

The Lord shall reign for ever,

even thy God, O Zion, unto all generations.

Praise ye the Lord.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of judgement and mercy:

Matthew 25:34-40

Then shall the King say unto them on his right hand, Come, ye blessed of my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world: For I was an hungred, and ye gave me meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me drink: I was a stranger, and ye took me in: Naked, and ye clothed me: I was sick, and ye visited me: I was in prison, and ye came unto me. Then shall the righteous answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, and fed thee? or thirsty, and gave thee drink? When saw we thee a stranger, and took thee in? or naked, and clothed thee? Or when saw we thee sick, or in prison, and came unto thee? And the King shall answer and say unto them, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider:

1. 'I was an hungred, and ye gave me meat.' Christ so identifies with the suffering that to serve them is to serve him. This is not metaphor, it is mystical reality. The face of the homeless person is the face of Christ. The need of the refugee is the need of Christ.
2. 'When saw we thee?' The righteous are surprised. They did not know they were serving Christ; they simply served

those in need. True mercy does not calculate reward or seek recognition. It serves because it sees need, and that is enough.

3. 'One of the least of these my brethren.' Christ's brothers and sisters are not only the impressive, the influential, the important. They are especially the least; the overlooked, the forgotten, the ones the world considered worthless. These are Christ's preferred disguise.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayers:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but

deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for those in need:

O heavenly Father, whose blessed Son came not to be ministered unto but to minister: We beseech thee to bless all who, following in his steps, give themselves to the service of their fellow men. Endue them with wisdom, patience, and courage, that they may strengthen the weak and raise up those who fall, and, being inspired by thy love, may worthily minister in thy Name to the suffering, the friendless, and the needy; for the sake of him who laid down his life for us, thy Son our Saviour Jesus Christ. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for the poor, the hungry, the homeless, the sick, and the imprisoned.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: Who are 'the least of these' in your life? What works of mercy is God calling you to perform this day? How might you see Christ in those you serve?

Lord Jesus Christ, who hast told us that in serving the poor we serve thee: Open my eyes to see thee in the faces of those in need. Give me courage to approach rather than avoid. Give me generosity to give rather than hoard. Give me compassion to enter into suffering rather than protect myself from it.

Show me this day one person who hungers; for food, for companionship, for meaning. Show me one person who thirsts; for water, for justice, for love. Show me one stranger who needs welcome, one naked soul who needs covering, one sick heart who needs visiting, one imprisoned spirit who needs liberation.

And in serving them, let me find thee. For thou hast said that what I do to them, I do to thee. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Go forth into the world as servants of Christ. Feed the hungry. Give drink to the thirsty. Welcome the stranger. Clothe the naked. Visit the sick. Come to the imprisoned. And in serving them, serve him who served you by laying down his life. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you always. Amen.

THE TWENTY-NINTH DAY

The Blessed Hope

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle. Keep one minute of silence, lifting your heart to the future that God has promised; the return of Christ, the resurrection of the dead, the renewal of all things. Let hope rise within you, for this present suffering is not worthy to be compared with the glory that shall be revealed.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from the Advent liturgy:

Almighty God, who hast given us thy only-begotten Son to take our nature upon him: Grant that we, who have been reborn and made thy children by adoption and grace, may daily be renewed by thy Holy Spirit, and joyfully await the blessed hope and glorious appearing of our great God and Saviour Jesus Christ; who liveth and reigneth with thee and the same Spirit, one God, now and for ever. Even so, come, Lord Jesus. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one whose hope has grown dim:

Almighty God, who hast promised that thy Son will come again in glory: I confess that I have lived without hope. I have fixed my eyes on the present and forgotten the future. I have been so absorbed in the world's troubles that I have neglected the world's destiny. I have grown so comfortable in this age that I have ceased to long for the age to come.

I confess that I have grieved as those who have no hope. I have feared death as though it were the end. I have lived as though this world were all there is, rather than the anteroom of eternity.

Forgive my hopelessness. Rekindle in me the blessed hope of Christ's appearing. Lift my eyes from the troubles of this present time to the glory that shall be revealed. And grant that I may live this day as one who awaits the bridegroom. Through Jesus Christ, who is coming again. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

God, who raised Jesus from the dead, will also raise you. Your hopelessness is forgiven; your horizon is expanded. The God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, that you may abound in hope by the power of the Holy Spirit. Go in peace, awaiting the blessed hope. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 98, the psalm of God's coming:

O sing unto the Lord a new song;

for he hath done marvellous things:

his right hand, and his holy arm, hath gotten him the victory.

The Lord hath made known his salvation:

his righteousness hath he openly shewed in the sight of the heathen.

He hath remembered his mercy and his truth toward the house of Israel:

all the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God.

Make a joyful noise unto the Lord, all the earth:

make a loud noise, and rejoice, and sing praise.

Sing unto the Lord with the harp;

with the harp, and the voice of a psalm.

With trumpets and sound of cornet

make a joyful noise before the Lord, the King.

Let the sea roar, and the fulness thereof;

the world, and they that dwell therein.

Let the floods clap their hands:

let the hills be joyful together

Before the Lord; for he cometh to judge the earth:

with righteousness shall he judge the world,

and the people with equity.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of hope:

Titus 2:11-14; Romans 8:18-25

For the grace of God that bringeth salvation hath appeared to all men, Teaching us that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we should live soberly, righteously, and godly, in this present world; Looking for that blessed hope, and the glorious appearing of the great God and our Saviour Jesus Christ; Who gave himself for us, that he might redeem us from all iniquity, and purify unto himself a peculiar people, zealous of good works... For I reckon that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which shall be revealed in us. For the earnest expectation of the creature waiteth for the manifestation of the sons of God... For we are saved by hope: but hope that is seen is not hope: for what a man seeth, why doth he yet hope for? But if we hope for that we see not, then do we with patience wait for it.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider:

1. 'Looking for that blessed hope.' Christian living is shaped by Christian hoping. The blessed hope is not escapism but the lens through which we see all of present reality. Those who truly hope for Christ's return live differently now; more soberly, more righteously, more godly.
2. 'The sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which shall be revealed.' This is not denial of suffering but perspective on suffering. Present pain is real, but it is not ultimate. The weight of glory that awaits makes current affliction seem light and momentary.
3. 'The earnest expectation of the creature waiteth.' All creation groans for redemption; not destruction but

renewal. The Christian hope is not the abandonment of creation but its transformation. The same God who raised Jesus will raise you and make all things new.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending especially to the final articles:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayers:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for the Second Coming:

O God, who hast taught us that the night is far spent and the day is at hand: Grant that we may ever be found watching for the coming

of thy Son; that when he shall appear we may not be ashamed, but may have confidence and joy at his appearing; who liveth and reigneth with thee and the Holy Spirit, one God, world without end. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, especially for those who have lost hope and those who mourn.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: What would change if you truly believed in and lived in light of Christ's return? How does the blessed hope shape your response to present suffering? To present opportunities?

Lord Jesus Christ, who hast promised to come again: I confess that I live too often as though this world were my home and this life were all there is. Awaken in me the longing for thy appearing. Let me live this day as one who expects thee — not with anxiety but with anticipation, not with fear but with hope.

And for those who suffer, who grieve, who have lost hope — let the blessed hope be their comfort. Let them know that neither death nor life, nor things present nor things to come, can separate them from thy love. Let them see beyond present affliction to coming glory.

Come, Lord Jesus. Come quickly. And until thou comest, keep me watching, waiting, working, hoping. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.

℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

May the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, that you may abound in hope by the power of the Holy Spirit. And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, be upon you and remain with you, now and unto the day of Christ. Amen.

THE THIRTIETH DAY

The Vision of God

I. Preparation of the Heart

Light your candle for the last time in this cycle of devotion. Keep one minute of silence, lifting your heart to the ultimate destiny for which you were made; not merely heaven as a place of reward, but the vision of God himself, the beatific vision, the seeing of Love face to face. This is what you were made for. This is where all prayer tends.

℣. O Lord, open thou our lips.

℟. **And our mouth shall show forth thy praise.**

℣. O God, make speed to save us.

℟. **O Lord, make haste to help us.**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Pray this invocation adapted from Augustine:

O God, who art the light of the minds that know thee, the life of the souls that love thee, and the strength of the wills that serve thee: Help us so to know thee that we may truly love thee, and so to love thee that we may fully serve thee, whom to serve is perfect freedom. And grant that at the last, when faith shall turn to sight and hope to possession, we may see thee as thou art and be transformed into thy likeness, going from glory to glory, until we stand complete in thy presence, beholding thy face forever. Through Jesus Christ our Lord, who with thee and the Holy Spirit liveth and reigneth, one God, world without end. Amen.

II. Confession and Absolution

Kneel. Confess as one who has been distracted from the one thing needful:

Almighty God, who hast made us for thyself, that we might know thee and enjoy thee forever: I confess that I have sought my happiness in a thousand places other than thy presence. I have been distracted by lesser loves, absorbed by passing pleasures, captured by fading glories. I have preferred the gifts to the Giver, the blessings to the Blesser, the creation to the Creator.

I confess that even my religion has sometimes been a substitute for thee rather than a means to thee. I have sought experiences about thee rather than experience of thee. I have been content with glimpses when thou dost offer vision.

Forgive my wandering heart. Focus my scattered desires. Unite my divided will. And grant that I may seek one thing only; to dwell in thy house all the days of my life, to gaze upon thy beauty, to inquire in thy temple, and at the last to see thee face to face. Amen.

Receive the absolution:

God, who desires to be known by you more than you desire to know him, forgives your wandering and welcomes your return. Even now he draws you toward the vision of himself. One day you will see him as he is and be like him, for you will see him. Until then, go in peace, and let the longing grow. Amen.

III. Adoration

Stand. Pray Psalm 27:1, 4-6, 13-14:

The Lord is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear?

the Lord is the strength of my life; of whom shall I be afraid?

One thing have I desired of the Lord, that will I seek after;

that I may dwell in the house of the Lord all the days of my life,

to behold the beauty of the Lord, and to enquire in his temple.

For in the time of trouble he shall hide me in his pavilion:

in the secret of his tabernacle shall he hide me;

he shall set me up upon a rock.

And now shall mine head be lifted up above mine enemies round about me:

therefore will I offer in his tabernacle sacrifices of joy;

I will sing, yea, I will sing praises unto the Lord.

I had fainted, unless I had believed to see

the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living.

Wait on the Lord: be of good courage,

and he shall strengthen thine heart: wait, I say, on the Lord.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

IV. Scripture and Meditation

Sit. Receive the word of the vision of God

1 John 3:1-3; 1 Corinthians 13:9-12; Revelation 22:3-5

Behold, what manner of love the Father hath bestowed upon us, that we should be called the sons of God: therefore the world knoweth us not, because it knew him not. Beloved, now are we the sons of God, and it doth not yet appear what we shall be: but we know that, when he shall appear, we shall be like him; for we shall see him as he is. And every man that hath this hope in him purifieth himself, even as he is pure... For we know in part, and we prophesy in part. But when that which is perfect is come, then that which is in part shall be done away... For now we see through a glass, darkly; but then face to face: now I know in part; but then shall I know even as also I am known... And there shall be no more curse: but the throne of God and of the Lamb shall be in it; and his servants shall serve him: And they shall see his face; and his name shall be in their foreheads. And there shall be no night there; and they need no candle, neither light of the sun; for the Lord God giveth them light: and they shall reign for ever and ever.

Keep two minutes of silence. Then consider:

1. 'We shall be like him; for we shall see him as he is.' Seeing and becoming are linked. We are transformed by what we behold. The beatific vision is not merely passive observation but active transformation; we become what we see, we are changed into what we gaze upon.
2. 'Now we see through a glass, darkly; but then face to face.' All our present knowledge of God is mediated, partial, obscured. But a day is coming when the veil will be removed, the mirror set aside, the darkness scattered. We shall know as we are known.
3. 'They shall see his face.' This is the heart of heaven; not golden streets or pearly gates, not even reunion with loved ones, but the face of God. To see that face, to gaze forever

upon infinite Beauty, infinite Love, infinite Truth; this is the satisfaction of every desire, the end of every longing.

Spend 3-5 minutes in silent meditation.

V. The Creed and Prayers

Stand for the Creed, attending to these words as a summary of the journey toward God:

I believe in God, the Father Almighty, creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried. He descended to the dead. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty. From thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

Kneel or sit for prayers:

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever. Amen.

Pray this collect for the vision of God:

O God, who hast prepared for them that love thee such good things as pass man's understanding: Pour into our hearts such love toward thee, that we, loving thee in all things and above all things, may

obtain thy promises, which exceed all that we can desire. And grant that we, being purified from all earthly desires, may attain at last to the vision of thy glory; where, with all thy saints, we shall see thee face to face and be satisfied forevermore; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Add your own intercessions, offering to God the desires and hopes of your heart.

VI. Self-Examination and Intention

Consider: Is the vision of God the deepest desire of your heart? What would it mean to order all of life toward this ultimate end? How might the practices of these thirty days prepare you for that eternal beholding?

O God, my God, thou art what I desire. Not thy gifts only, but thee. Not heaven only, but the God of heaven. Not blessing only, but the Blesser. Thou hast made me for thyself, and I will not rest until I rest in thee.

For these thirty days thou hast drawn me into thy presence through prayer, through Scripture, through confession and absolution, through silence and meditation. Let these disciplines not end with this cycle but continue as the daily rhythm of my life; not as mere habit but as the path toward the vision of thy face.

And when at last I see thee as thou art, let me recognize the One I have sought so long, the One who has sought me even longer. For thou hast loved me with an everlasting love, and thy mercy has pursued me all my days. And though I have seen thee only through a glass darkly, the day is coming when I shall see thee face to face. Until then, keep me faithful. Until then, keep me longing. Until then, keep me pressing on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus. Amen.

VII. Commendation and Blessing

Stand.

℣. The Lord be with you.
℟. **And with thy spirit.**

Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

The Lord bless you and keep you. The Lord make his face to shine upon you and be gracious unto you. The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace. And may you, beholding as in a mirror the glory of the Lord, be transformed into his image from glory to glory, until the day when you see him face to face and are satisfied forevermore. In the Name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

FINIS

Soli Deo Gloria

These thirty days of prayer are offered to the Church as a humble contribution to the tradition of Anglican devotion. May they form hearts in the ancient way, that rising each morning, God's people may present themselves as living sacrifices, holy and acceptable, which is their reasonable service.

A Note on the Texts

The liturgical structure of this devotional draws from the Daily Office as codified in the Book of Common Prayer (1662). The versicles, responses, Gloria Patri, Apostles' Creed, and Lord's Prayer follow the traditional forms of that edition.

Scripture passages are quoted from the King James Version (1611), chosen for its cadence and its continuity with the liturgical tradition in which this book stands.

Invocations and prayers have been adapted from the following sources, all of which are in the public domain: the Prayers of Lancelot Andrewes; the Proslogion of Anselm of Canterbury; the Confessions and sermons of Augustine of Hippo; the writings of Bernard of Clairvaux; the poems of George Herbert; the Against Heresies of Irenaeus of Lyon; the Imitation of Christ attributed to Thomas à Kempis; the Holy Living of Jeremy Taylor; and the hymns of Charles Wesley.

The Agnus Dei, Te Deum, Gloria in Excelsis, Veni Creator Spiritus, Benedictus, Phos Hilaron, and other canticles are drawn from the historic liturgies of the Western Church and are in the public domain.

Where invocations have been substantially adapted rather than lightly edited, they are described as "adapted from" rather than quoted directly.

About the Author

Nathanael Thie is a writer, musician, tutor, and lay Anglican born and raised in Sydney, Australia. He serves in music, welcome, and mission at St George Anglican Church, Hurstville, and in student ministry at the University of New South Wales. His writing engages the intersection of classical Anglican theology, patristic spirituality, and the renewal of liturgical devotion in the contemporary Church.

Incline My Heart is his first published work.

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